STRATA: One Geometry-Free Persistence-and-Periodicity Engine for Selectable 2D/3D Lifelong LiDAR Mapping

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A robot that maps one building for weeks must keep walls, forget movers and treat a scheduled door as signal. Occupancy mappers make the first two decisions with a log-odds accumulator whose increments were chosen by habit. We show that the OctoMap increments (+0.85, −0.4) are the increments of Wald's sequential probability ratio test (SPRT) between the hit rates 0.1975 and 0.4621, so that "Static" means "occupied in more than about a third of the windows", and that a multiplicative leak removes the property on which an error bound rests. STRATA 0.2 makes the test explicit: the user states two hit rates and two error rates, increments and thresholds follow, and a cell ends Static, Rejected or Undecided. Under independent windows, clutter at a hit rate of at most m_0 is declared Static in one cell history with probability at most 0.0101 (Ville's inequality), and the operating characteristic measured on the engine matches the exact computation of the rule and is approximated by Wald's closed form; at a lag-1 autocorrelation of 0.23 the per-history rate is 3.49 times the bound. We derived the pair under a pre-registered rule, but the wall-thickness gate failed on every calibration sequence, so the shipped pair $(0.20, 0.70, 0.01, 0.01)$ is provisional and the 3D pair is not calibrated. On held-out LILocBench, Oxford Spires, KTH-benchmark and Boreas data we compare seven evidence rules, without tuning and without choosing a winner. On LILocBench clutter, 8.81 % of the cells are ever Static under the sequential test (2.93 % at an observed hit rate of at most m_0) against 21.16 % under v0.1; both exceed the nominal $\alpha = 0.01$, which is per history, not per cell. The sequential test rejects none of the 366 wall-run cells and needs a median of 33 windows to graduate one, against 10. The engine is one geometry-free state machine for a 2D grid and a 3D voxel hash, with a FreMEn-style periodic label whose false-alarm bound holds for iid clutter; Periodic is validated on synthetic streams only. Code: `https://github.com/kjungmo/strata`.

Keywords: lifelong mapping, occupancy grids, sequential probability ratio test, persistence filtering, FreMEn periodicity, ROS 2

1. Introduction

An occupancy grid built the textbook way accumulates evidence and never lets go of it (Thrun et al., 2005). For a robot that drives a route once this is harmless; for one that maps the same warehouse or hospital corridor for weeks it is a slow failure. A cart parked for an afternoon, a person walking past and a load-bearing wall all leave the same kind of mark, and after enough passes the map describes the union of everything the sensor ever touched rather than the building. Lifelong mapping has to hold three requirements at once: the map must be *durable* enough to keep structure that is genuinely permanent, *plastic* enough to forget structure that has moved on, and it must do both without one global forgetting rate that is simultaneously too slow to erase movers and too fast to trust

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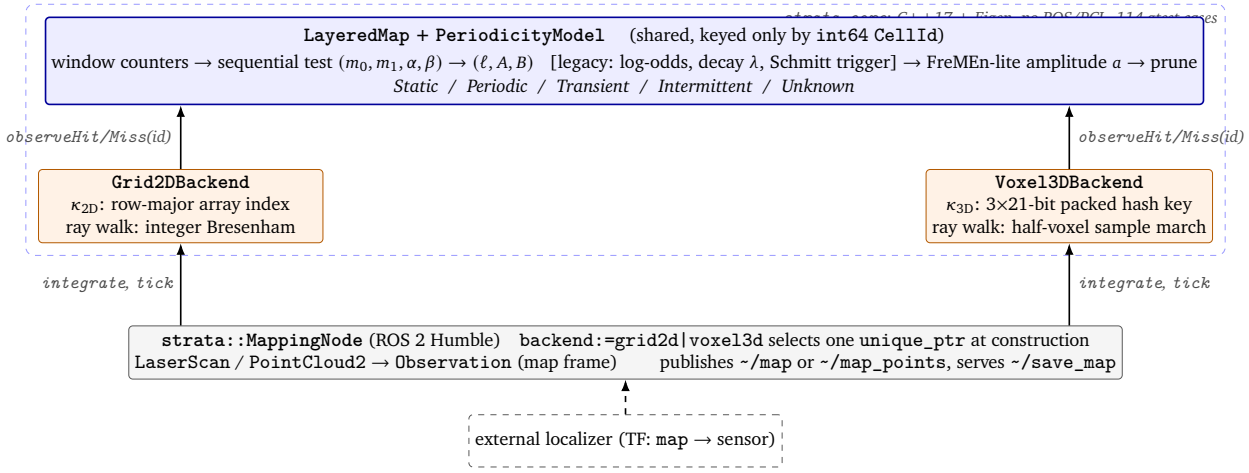


Figure 1: Overview of STRATA. One geometry-free engine (top) owns every persistence and periodicity decision and sees only integer cell keys. The two backends (middle) contribute exactly two things: the point-to-key map κ_b and the free-space ray walk. A thin ROS 2 node (bottom) selects one backend from a single string parameter and consumes, but never produces, the sensor pose.

a wall—the stability–plasticity dilemma that Biber and Duckett (2005) framed for dynamic maps. A third requirement complicates the split: some structure is *cyclic*, such as a door open every morning and shut every night. Its occupancy is a periodic temporal signal, and a flat decay law erases exactly the regularity that makes it predictable (Krajník et al., 2014a, 2017).

Per-cell models of these requirements are not new. Temporal occupancy grids (Arbuckle et al., 2002) classify cells by their occupancy over several timescales, and Mitsou and Tzafestas (2007) keep each cell's occupancy history to separate static, low-dynamic and high-dynamic cells. The closest prior work is the FreMEn line: Krajník et al. (2016) maintain a 2D spatio-temporal occupancy grid that represents the persistence and periodicity of individual cells and was evaluated on several days of patrols in an open-plan office, and FROctomap (Krajník et al., 2014b) attaches the same spectral model to the voxels of an octree. Recent LiDAR systems place the persistence decision inside larger pipelines. ELite (Gil et al., 2025) updates a per-point ephemerality with a Bayes rule; LT-mapper (Kim and Kim, 2022) and Khronos (Schmid et al., 2024) resolve durability against plasticity as stages of full lifelong-SLAM or metric-semantic systems; and MTD-Map (Kim et al., 2026), concurrent with this work, maintains static, dynamic and transition maps from per-voxel occupancy statistics. Dynamic-point removal methods decide the same question offline or per scan (Duberg et al., 2024; Jia et al., 2024; Kim and Kim, 2020; Lim et al., 2021).

Several of these systems keep a number per cell or point that hits push up and misses push down, and compare it with a threshold. As far as we can tell from the papers, none of them states the test that the number performs: which two hit rates it tells apart, and with which error. For the log-odds accumulator of OctoMap (Hornung et al., 2013) the answer is a short calculation, and it is not what a user would choose. The increments (+0.85, −0.4) are the increments of Wald's sequential probability ratio test (Wald, 1947) between the hit rates 0.1975 and 0.4621 (Section 4). A cell whose hit rate is above about a third then drifts toward Static, and a leak that shrinks the statistic every window removes the property on which a bound on the error rests. The first release of STRATA used exactly this rule, and in a synthetic test 1960 of 2000 Bernoulli(0.5) clutter cells ended Static.

We present *STRATA* 0.2, a SLAM-free persistence-and-periodicity engine in which the test is explicit (Figure 1). The user states the hit rate m_0 at or below which a cell is clutter, the hit rate m_1 at or above which it is structure, and two error rates; increments and thresholds are derived, and every

cell ends Static, Rejected or Undecided. The same per-cell state machine serves a fixed-array 2D grid and a sparse 3D voxel hash, which differ only in the point-to-key map and the ray walk: the state machine never sees coordinates, the engine (`strata_core`) links no ROS, DDS, TF or PCL, and choosing 2D or 3D is one runtime string parameter. We state the scope up front: STRATA is not SLAM (it consumes an external `map`→sensor transform), it models single-session persistence rather than multi-session remapping, its periodicity test checks one configured base period and its harmonics rather than selecting periods as FreMEn does, and its default pair is provisional. Our contributions are:

- *The test, made explicit.* The increments of a log-odds accumulator determine a pair of hit rates (Proposition 5). The OctoMap increments, which the first release used, are a sequential probability ratio test between 0.1975 and 0.4621 (Section 4.1), and a multiplicative leak breaks the supermartingale property that an error bound needs (Proposition 6). We did not find an earlier statement of either fact. ELite (Gil et al., 2025) already accumulates a likelihood ratio per point, symmetric at zero distance from the ray, and MTD-Map (Kim et al., 2026) already maintains a per-voxel Markov statistic; we cite both, run the factors of ELite as one arm of the evaluation, and did not build an arm for MTD-Map because we found no released code.
- *Defaults derived from stated error rates.* From $(m_0, m_1, \alpha, \beta)$ the engine derives increments, thresholds, a cap, a reverse test for demotion, a periodicity gate and a truncation, with three outcomes instead of two. Under independent windows the probability that clutter at a rate of at most m_0 ever graduates in one cell history is at most $\alpha/(1-\beta)$ (Proposition 7, by Ville's inequality). The operating characteristic measured on the engine matches the exact lattice computation and is approximated by Wald's closed form (E7), and the committed Monte Carlo shows how autocorrelated windows inflate the rate.
- *Calibration and held-out evaluation on real data, reported as measured.* We calibrated the pair on LILocBench under a pre-registered rule with quality gates; the gate failed, nothing froze, and the shipped pair is provisional (Section 6). We then ran seven evidence rules on LILocBench, Oxford Spires, the KTH benchmark and Boreas without tuning and without choosing a winner (Section 7). The realised per-cell false-Static rates are above the nominal per-history level, and we say so.
- *One geometry-free engine for two geometries, with a calibrated periodic label.* A single `int64`-keyed engine (`LayeredMap` with `PeriodicityModel`) drives both backends through one `MapBackend` interface and builds with C++17 and Eigen alone under 114 behaviour-level tests. A known moment-generating-function bound (Hsu et al., 2012), applied to the floating-mean periodogram (Zechmeister and Kürster, 2009) and spent over the touch count in the manner of alpha spending (Lan and DeMets, 1983), bounds the probability that the periodic label fires on iid clutter. The periodic label is validated on synthetic streams only.

In the synthetic suite, which runs in two arms (the first release's arithmetic and the sequential test), the sequential test graduates an always-hit wall at its derived 4th window instead of the third and labels 1120 instead of 1960 of the 2000 Bernoulli(0.5) clutter cells Static, a rate that the pair does not promise to control between its two hypotheses. On real data, the sequential test graduates fewer clutter cells than the first release's rule, waits longer to graduate walls and leaves more structure Undecided; none of the compared rules is shown to be a good removal method on these data (Section 7). Whether the calibrated periodic test improves on FreMEn's own component selection, and whether it finds doors in real data, remain to be evaluated (Section 8).

2. Related Work

Lifelong and persistent mapping. ELite (Gil et al., 2025) scores each point's ephemerality at two timescales and maintains a lifelong/static/delta map triad; its local score is updated by a Bayes rule whose factor depends on the distance of the map point from the ray, and at zero distance the odds factors printed in the paper are 1/9 for an endpoint and 9 for a sampled free point, a symmetric likelihood ratio with, as printed, no clamp and no leak (our arithmetic from its Eqs. (5) and (6)); LT-mapper (Kim and Kim, 2022) composes live, meta and delta maps through explicit alignment, removal and change-management stages. Khronos (Schmid et al., 2024) splits an active window from a long-term reconstruction with semantics, and Yang et al. (2024) keep versioned deltas over a base map so that past sessions can be rebuilt. Classifying cells by their temporal behaviour predates these systems. Temporal occupancy grids (Arbuckle et al., 2002) classify cells by occupancy over several timescales with planar laser range-finders and locate doors in a real-world setting; Mitsou and Tzafestas (2007) index every cell's occupancy history over time and separate static, low-dynamic and high-dynamic cells, in simulation with known poses. Multi-timescale and static/temporary map splits follow in Biber and Duckett (2005) and Meyer-Delius et al. (2010). Pomerleau et al. (2014) infer online whether each 3D point is static or dynamic from repeated observations, over seven months of data, and Berrio et al. (2022) describe a long-term map maintenance pipeline for autonomous vehicles. For 2D occupancy grids, Stefanini et al. (2022, 2023) update a LiDAR occupancy map for long-term operation while accounting for localisation error, with the aim of keeping the map current rather than modelling periodic change. Two 2026 works, concurrent with this one, produce layered outputs: MTD-Map (Kim et al., 2026) keeps per voxel an instantaneous occupancy probability, a long-term occupancy probability that is an exponential moving average, and a stability statistic that grows while consecutive observations agree, builds on a mixture transition distribution, and outputs static, dynamic and transition maps from hand-set thresholds on these three quantities, evaluated on real datasets against established baselines (it states no hypothesis test and no error rate), and Chen and Sun (2026) assign map content to long-term static, potentially dynamic and removed observed-dynamic layers from geometric and semantic evidence. Neither describes an explicit periodic class. STRATA implements only the graduation half of this pattern—one per-cell state machine with no scan matching, loop closure, session alignment, semantics or object layer—and is intended as the core such systems wrap, not a competitor; correspondingly, it lacks their multi-session and field-scale evidence. Its real-data evidence is limited to the evidence rule on four public datasets (Section 7).

Evidence rules in occupancy mapping and dynamic-point removal. OctoMap (Hornung et al., 2013) clamps the log-odds of a voxel between a lower and an upper bound so that the map can adapt, with the sensor-model increments 0.85 and −0.4, and the sensor model of the first release of STRATA is that pair; UFOMap (Duberg and Jensfelt, 2020) adds an explicit unknown state. Removert (Kim and Kim, 2020) conservatively retains definite static points and then reverts wrongly removed ones; ReFusion (Palazzolo et al., 2019) treats a reliably observed empty voxel as evidence, and STRATA uses free-space misses along each ray as the evidence that demotes a graduated cell, online and per cell; ERASOR (Lim et al., 2021) removes dynamic points from a ratio of pseudo-occupancy per polar bin, the ratio of the height ranges of the points in a bin of a scan and of the map, whose threshold of 0.2 is a ratio of heights and not a hit rate; DUFOMap (Duberg et al., 2024) marks a region as void once it has been observed empty and calls every point later found inside it dynamic, a one-shot rule without a rate; and BeautyMap (Jia et al., 2024) decides on a binary-encoded ground matrix. The KTH benchmark (Zhang et al., 2023) scores such methods on the retained static points (SA) and the removed dynamic points (DA) at point level, and BeautyMap defines the harmonic mean HA beside the geometric mean AA that the benchmark uses. The methods above decide with a threshold or a one-shot rule. STRATA decides with a rate-based sequential test whose hypotheses and error rates

are parameters, and its evaluation (Section 7) is not a removal benchmark.

Sequential analysis. Wald's sequential probability ratio test (Wald, 1947) stops as soon as the cumulative log-likelihood ratio crosses one of two thresholds; Wald and Wolfowitz (1948) prove that, among tests with the same error probabilities, it needs the fewest observations on average. Page's cumulative-sum procedure (Page, 1954) uses a reflecting lower barrier at zero; as Lorden (1971) recalls, Page observed that it is equivalent to repeating an SPRT on successive observations until it decides for the alternative. The engine of Section 4 differs from both: it has a floor only after a gate, and it ends a history when it rejects. Ville's inequality bounds the probability that a nonnegative supermartingale ever exceeds a level; Howard et al. (2020) state it as their Lemma 1 and note that the likelihood ratio, stopped above a threshold only, is an open-ended SPRT with a valid type-I error, and Ramdas et al. (2023) survey the resulting anytime-valid tests. We found no result that gives error rates for a Wald test with a multiplicative leak; leaky accumulators appear in models of decision making (Bogacz et al., 2006).

Persistence, forgetting and periodicity. The Persistence Filter (Rosen et al., 2016) estimates each feature's survival probability from a Bayesian survival-time model, and the Markov-chain occupancy models of Tipaldi et al. (2013) and Saarinen et al. (2012) learn per-cell transition rates. Perpetua (Saavedra-Ruiz et al., 2025) combines persistence and emergence filters under multiple hypotheses for features that disappear and reappear. FreMEn (Krajník et al., 2017), descending from spectral analysis of long-term maps (Krajník et al., 2014a), models cyclic occupancy with a few Fourier components selected by amplitude from a set of candidate periods, and it is the closest prior work to STRATA. Krajník et al. (2016) use it in a 2D spatio-temporal occupancy grid in which each cell represents both persistence (through the mean time between state changes) and periodicity; the grid integrates one map per patrol, replaces the ROS map server, and predicts time-specific maps for localisation and planning. FROctomap (Krajník et al., 2014b) applies the FreMEn spectral model to 3D octree voxels, the exploration work of Krajník et al. (2015) displays the static and daily-periodic cells of such a grid, and the open-source FreMEn repository (STRANDS Project, 2017) provides separate 2D-grid and octree packages, and also a generic server that maintains FreMEn models of arbitrary binary states keyed by an identifier. Warped hypertime (Krajník et al., 2019) extends the idea to pseudo-periodic variation. STRATA is narrower than this family in period modelling: it tests one configured base period and its harmonics and does not select periods. It differs from the family in two respects: its primary output is a discrete class, reached through a hysteresis band and pruning, rather than a predicted occupancy probability; and it attaches a finite-sample false-alarm bound to the periodic label. It also updates once per window, whereas the grid of Krajník et al. (2016) integrates one map per patrol. In its legacy evidence model STRATA uses the log-odds update of Thrun et al. (2005), clamped as in OctoMap (Hornung et al., 2013), and replaces the survival posterior with one global multiplicative decay (a constant-rate special case); the default model drops the decay (Section 4). In both models it runs a bounded FreMEn-style accumulator in parallel with graduation so that an oscillating cell is labelled Periodic instead of being mis-graduated or mis-pruned.

Map data structures and ROS 2 tooling. OctoMap (Hornung et al., 2013) and UFOMap (Duberg and Jensfelt, 2020) share the clamped log-odds core but compress space with octrees, the latter with an explicit unknown state; the voxel hash of Nießner et al. (2013) is the structure `voxel3d` follows. Nav2's spatio-temporal voxel layer (Macenski et al., 2020) decays costmap evidence for planning, layered costmaps (Lu et al., 2014) composite per-cell layers, and SLAM Toolbox (Macenski and Jambrecic, 2021) is a 2D SLAM library that includes prototype lifelong mapping. For swappable backends, ROS 2 offers `pluginlib` (Open Robotics, 2024); STRATA deliberately uses one interface and a two-way factory instead. Relative to the works above, the structural difference is narrow. Periodicity modelling that does not depend on geometry already exists, since the FreMEn server models any binary state that has an identifier (STRANDS Project, 2017). What STRATA shares, unchanged, between its 2D

and 3D ray-casting backends is the full cell-level state machine: windowed log-odds with survival decay, graduation and demotion hysteresis, pruning, layer classification and the periodicity test.

Periodicity tests and error control. The periodic test uses the generalised Lomb–Scargle periodogram (Zechmeister and Kürster, 2009). Analytic false-alarm probabilities for periodogram peaks, including the search over frequencies, are derived under white Gaussian noise (Baluev, 2008). For binary series, Schmidtke and Vetter (2026) test a constant success probability against a periodic one of unspecified period, with a level that holds asymptotically. STRATA addresses a narrower question: a finite-sample, distribution-free bound for independent Bernoulli occupancy at one configured period and its harmonics, under any sampling pattern fixed independently of the occupancy. Proposition 3 obtains it from the moment-generating-function bound for quadratic forms of sub-Gaussian vectors of Hsu et al. (2012, Remark 2), followed by Markov's inequality and a union bound, with the variance proxy of Hoeffding's lemma (Hoeffding, 1963); the result is an application of that bound, not a new inequality. Spending the level over the touch count (Proposition 4) is a Bonferroni-type allocation over repeated looks, related to the alpha-spending functions of group-sequential trials (Lan and DeMets, 1983); time-uniform bounds from nonnegative supermartingales (Howard et al., 2020) are the modern alternative for repeated testing. Section 4 uses them for the evidence test; the periodic label keeps the Bonferroni-type allocation.

3. STRATA: A Geometry-Free Engine Beneath Two Map Geometries

STRATA is delivered as two ROS 2 packages with a hard dependency boundary. `strata_core` holds the entire occupancy, persistence and periodicity logic together with both geometry backends, in C++17 with Eigen as its only third-party dependency. `strata` is a thin node that owns message conversion, TF lookups, publishers, a save service, file I/O and input diagnostics (Tables 27 and 28). This section specifies the engine exactly as implemented: every equation is transcribed from `strata_core`, and §3.7 lists where the code departs from the design document. Table 31 collects the symbols. The engine has two evidence models. `evidence_model = legacy` is the rule of the first release, specified in §3.2 and 3.3. `evidence_model = sprt` is the default of version 0.2, a sequential probability ratio test specified in Section 4. Geometry, windows, the periodicity test, pruning and the read-out are shared by both models.

Problem Setup: One Classifier, Any Geometry. A sensor sweep at integration tick k delivers an origin $\mathbf{o}_k \in \mathbb{R}^3$ and a set of hit endpoints $\mathcal{P}_k \subset \mathbb{R}^3$, both already in the map frame (the pose comes from an external localizer). A backend $b \in \{2D, 3D\}$ supplies two operators only: a key map $\kappa_b : \mathbb{R}^3 \to C \cup \{\perp\}$ onto integer cell ids $C \subset \mathbb{Z}$, and a ray walk $\rho_b(\mathbf{o}, \mathbf{p}) \subset C$ listing the free cells between origin and endpoint. Ticks are grouped into windows $w = 1, 2, \ldots$. Each live cell i carries a state $\mathbf{x}_i = (\ell_i, N_i, g_i, \boldsymbol{\phi}_i)$—log-odds occupancy, touched-window count, graduated flag and Fourier accumulators—and the map reads out a class $c_i \in \{\mathsf{U}, \mathsf{T}, \mathsf{P}, \mathsf{S}\}$ (Unknown, Transient, Periodic, Static); the sequential model adds a fifth read-out, Intermittent (Section 4). The design objective is that the per-window map update factor as

$$\mathcal{X}_w = \Phi\big(\mathcal{X}_{w-1},\ \Gamma_b(\{(\mathbf{o}_k, \mathcal{P}_k)\}_{k \in w})\big), \qquad c_i = \Psi(\mathbf{x}_i), \tag{1}$$

where only the evidence extractor Γ_b depends on the backend, while the engine Φ and the read-out Ψ are written once and see nothing but integer ids. The classes should make walls *durable* (S persists under clutter), movers *plastic* (T cells are forgotten), and cyclic structure *periodic* (P is neither baked into S nor pruned). The stages below instantiate Γ_b, Φ and Ψ; Algorithm 1 gives the complete window update.

3.1. Keying Observations: Reducing Geometry to Integer Cell Ids

For every endpoint $\mathbf{p} \in \mathcal{P}_k$ that the backend accepts ($\kappa_b(\mathbf{p}) \neq \perp$) it registers one miss on each cell of $\rho_b(\mathbf{o}_k, \mathbf{p})$ and then one hit on $\kappa_b(\mathbf{p})$; an endpoint it does not accept contributes nothing, not even its ray. The engine keeps only per-window counters,

$$h_{i,w} = \sum_{k \in w} \sum_{\mathbf{p} \in \mathcal{P}_k} \big[\kappa_b(\mathbf{p}) = i\big], \qquad m_{i,w} = \sum_{k \in w} \sum_{\mathbf{p} \in \mathcal{P}_k} \big|\{j \in \rho_b(\mathbf{o}_k, \mathbf{p}) : j = i\}\big|, \tag{2}$$

creating a cell lazily on first touch with $\ell_i = 0$, $N_i = 0$, $g_i = \text{false}$. This is Γ_b; it is the only backend-specific code.

Fixed 2D grid. `Grid2DBackend` addresses an array of W columns and R rows with resolution r and origin (x_0, y_0), drops z, and maps a point to a row-major index,

$$\kappa_{2D}(\mathbf{p}) = \left\lfloor \frac{p_y - y_0}{r} \right\rfloor W + \left\lfloor \frac{p_x - x_0}{r} \right\rfloor, \tag{3}$$

returning $\perp$ outside the array. An endpoint outside the array is dropped together with its ray: a beam that ends beyond the array registers no hit and clears no cell, including the cells it crosses inside the array. ρ_{2D} is integer Bresenham (Bresenham, 1965) from the sensor cell up to but excluding the hit cell, so the sensor cell is included and the hit cell receives only its hit. A sweep whose origin lies outside the array registers its hits but clears no ray. The node adds a filter of its own before the backend: its scan adapter drops every beam whose range is not finite or lies outside [`range_min`, `range_max`], so a beam without a return clears nothing, and a reading equal to `range_max` is kept as a hit.

Sparse 3D hash. `Voxel3DBackend` floor-divides each axis by the voxel size v, offsets it by 2^{20} to keep it non-negative, and packs the three 21-bit fields into one 64-bit key,

$$\kappa_{3D}(\mathbf{p}) = (u_x \ll 42) \,\big|\, (u_y \ll 21) \,\big|\, u_z, \qquad u_a = \lfloor p_a / v \rfloor + 2^{20}. \tag{4}$$

The map grows through the hash and needs no preallocated extent. Its key space is nevertheless finite: each 21-bit field represents the indices -2^{20} to $2^{20} - 1$ around the origin, far beyond the extent of a building at the default voxel size, and the code does not check this range, so a point outside it would receive a wrong key rather than being dropped. ρ_{3D} is a sample march rather than an exact voxel traversal: with $\mathbf{d} = \mathbf{p} - \mathbf{o}$ and $S = \lfloor \|\mathbf{d}\| / (v/2) \rfloor$ half-voxel steps, the interior samples $\mathbf{o} + s\,\mathbf{d}/\max(S, 1)$, $s = 1, \ldots, S-1$, are hashed with (4). This is simpler than exact traversal but can visit a voxel more than once along a long ray and can skip a thin one when S rounds down.

3.2. Accumulating Evidence: Windowed Log-Odds with Survival Decay (the v0.1 Rule)

This subsection and the next specify the evidence rule of the first release, `evidence_model = legacy`, which the experiments run as the *legacy arm*. The default model replaces Eq. (6) by the sequential test of Section 4; windows, scoring and everything that follows the evidence update are shared.

A window closes on integration tick k when $L \leq 1$ or $k \bmod L = 0$, with L the `layer_interval`. The ROS node can instead close windows every `window_period_s` seconds of message time (`window_mode time`, the shipped setting; the code default and every experiment use L): windows are counted from the first header stamp, a message stamped past the open window first closes it and every silent window since, and a message with a zero stamp is dropped. A window that observes nothing changes no cell, so a silent gap of k windows is exactly k updates done in one pass; silent windows advance the phase without a touch, so within one uninterrupted stream of message time,

and as long as message loss and TF drops are independent of occupancy, the false-alarm bound of §3.4 holds in either mode and only the period, and with it the power, depends on the window rule. A stamp more than half a window behind the newest one (a bag loop, a clock reset) or more than 10^6 windows ahead (an unset stamp followed by a real one) closes the open window and re-anchors the window clock, while cell histories carry on; neither the bound nor the persistence evidence holds across such a jump, so restart the node rather than loop a bag. Scan-counted windows last L divided by the rate of messages actually integrated (§8). The update then scores every live cell once, so a single hit outweighs any number of misses in the same window:

$$\tau_i = [h_{i,w} > 0 \vee m_{i,w} > 0], \qquad o_i = [h_{i,w} > 0], \qquad f_i = [h_{i,w} = 0 \wedge m_{i,w} > 0]. \tag{5}$$

For *touched* cells only ($\tau_i = 1$), one log-odds increment is applied, multiplied by the survival decay λ, and clamped:

$$\ell_i \leftarrow \min\Big(l_{\max}, \max\big(l_{\min},\ \lambda\,(\ell_i + o_i\, l_{\text{hit}} + f_i\, l_{\text{miss}})\big)\Big), \qquad N_i \leftarrow N_i + 1, \tag{6}$$

with occupancy probability $p_i = \sigma(\ell_i) = 1/(1 + e^{-\ell_i})$. The update is the inverse-sensor-model rule of Thrun et al. (2005) with a constant-rate special case of the Persistence Filter's forgetting (Rosen et al., 2016). The order matters: the decay multiplies the *already incremented* value, so the fresh evidence is itself attenuated in the same window.

Proposition 1 (Saturation under repeated hits)**.** *If a cell is hit in every window,* $0 < \lambda < 1$, $l_{\text{hit}} > 0$ *and* $l_{\min} \le 0 < l_{\max}$, *then* ℓ_i *converges monotonically from* 0 *to* $\min(l_{\max}, \ell^\star)$ *with* $\ell^\star = \lambda l_{\text{hit}}/(1-\lambda)$.

Proof. Without the clamp the recursion is $\ell \mapsto \lambda(\ell + l_{\text{hit}})$, an affine contraction with factor λ and unique fixed point $\ell^\star$; from $\ell = 0 < \ell^\star$ the iterates increase monotonically towards it. The clamp is monotone and, since every iterate is non-negative and $l_{\min} \le 0$, only the upper bound can bind, so the clamped iterates increase to $\min(l_{\max}, \ell^\star)$. □

With the shipped defaults (Table 25; λ=0.97, l_{hit}=0.85) $\ell^\star \approx 27.5$, so the clamp binds at $l_{\max}$=5 and $p_{\max} = \sigma(5) \approx 0.9933$. The default thresholds p_{grad}=0.8 and p_{prune}=0.05 correspond to $\ell \ge \ln 4 \approx 1.386$ and $\ell < \ln(1/19) \approx -2.944$.

3.3. Gating Graduation: A Schmitt Trigger Against Flicker

After the log-odds step, p_i and the periodicity amplitude a_i (§3.4) are recomputed for *every* cell, touched or not, and the graduated flag follows a two-sided Schmitt trigger with two periodicity guards, evaluated in this order:

$$\text{graduate:}\quad \neg g_i \wedge \neg\pi_i \wedge p_i \ge p_{\text{grad}} \wedge N_i \ge N_{\min} \ \Rightarrow\ g_i \leftarrow \text{true}, \tag{7}$$

$$\text{demote:}\quad g_i \wedge \big(p_i \le p_{\text{dem}} \vee \pi_i\big) \ \Rightarrow\ g_i \leftarrow \text{false}, \tag{8}$$

where π_i is the periodic predicate of (13). The interval $[p_{\text{dem}}, p_{\text{grad}}]$ is the hysteresis band: through the occupancy disjunct $p_i \le p_{\text{dem}}$, a Static cell demotes only after sustained contradicting evidence, not after one contradicting window—the failure that Removert's revert pass repairs after the fact (Kim and Kim, 2020) is prevented online. The guard $\neg\pi_i$ keeps a periodic cell out of the static map; the term $\vee\,\pi_i$ removes a Static cell that later reveals periodicity. That term lies outside the band and has no hysteresis of its own. It cannot, however, fire without contradicting evidence: with the centred amplitude of §3.4, π_i requires a cell to have been observed free in a substantial share of its touched windows (Remark 2), so a wall that is occupied whenever it is seen is never demoted by it. The

predicate also requires the noise-calibrated significance of Proposition 3, with its level spent over the touch count. A graduated cell is never pruned, so by Proposition 4 a wall whose occupancy is merely iid noise is demoted by this term with probability at most δ for as long as its history is not interrupted; a noisy wall that the occupancy disjunct demotes can afterwards be pruned and re-created, and the new history has a budget of its own. The term still acts in a single window when it does fire; E3 measures its cost in flicker with periodicity on (§5.4).

Remark 1 (Which occupancy rates graduate). The graduation rule sees a cell only through its log-odds. Take a cell that is touched in every window and occupied independently with probability m. While the clamp is inactive, (6) reads $\ell \leftarrow \lambda(\ell + x)$ with $\mathbb{E}\,x = m\,l_{\text{hit}} + (1-m)\,l_{\text{miss}}$. For $\lambda < 1$ the mean of ℓ converges to $\lambda\,\mathbb{E}\,x/(1-\lambda)$, which lies above the graduation threshold $\operatorname{logit} p_{\text{grad}}$ exactly when

$$m > m^{\dagger} = \frac{\frac{1-\lambda}{\lambda}\operatorname{logit} p_{\text{grad}} - l_{\text{miss}}}{l_{\text{hit}} - l_{\text{miss}}}. \tag{9}$$

For $\lambda = 1$ the same expression is the rate $-l_{\text{miss}}/(l_{\text{hit}} - l_{\text{miss}})$ above which the walk drifts upward. The shipped defaults give $m^{\dagger} = 0.354$ and the E2 parameters $m^{\dagger} = 0.5$. This is a statement about a mean, not a bound: it ignores the clamp and pruning, and fluctuations graduate cells below $m^{\dagger}$; E6 measures the transition (Table 12). Its consequence is that Static means no more than *occupied in more than roughly $m^{\dagger}$ of the touched windows*. The engine holds no evidence that separates a wall seen in 60% of its windows from clutter present in 50% of them. Section 4.1 gives the reason: the increments are a sequential probability ratio test whose hypotheses nobody chose.

Proposition 2 (No same-window oscillation). *If $p_{\text{dem}} < p_{\text{grad}}$, a cell that graduates by (7) in a window is not demoted by (8) in the same window.*

Proof. Graduation requires $\neg\pi_i$ and $p_i \geq p_{\text{grad}} > p_{\text{dem}}$, and p_i, π_i are not recomputed between (7) and (8), so both disjuncts of the demotion condition are false. □

3.4. Detecting Periodicity: A FreMEn-Lite Amplitude Test

In parallel with occupancy, every touched cell feeds an incremental Fourier model following FreMEn (Krajník et al., 2017). The model is restricted to one configured base period and its first harmonics; unlike FreMEn, it does not select periods from a candidate set, so a cycle whose frequency is not a harmonic of the base frequency is outside its scope. With window index w, base period T (in windows), H harmonics, $\omega = 2\pi/\max(1,T)$, occupancy sample $o_i \in \{0,1\}$ and $\theta_k = (k{+}1)\omega w$, the accumulators $\boldsymbol{\phi}_i = (n_i, S_{0,i}, C_{k,i}, S_{k,i}, E^c_{k,i}, E^s_{k,i})$ evolve as

$$n_i \mathrel{+}= 1, \quad S_{0,i} \mathrel{+}= o_i, \quad C_{k,i} \mathrel{+}= o_i \cos\theta_k, \quad S_{k,i} \mathrel{+}= o_i \sin\theta_k, \quad E^c_{k,i} \mathrel{+}= \cos\theta_k, \quad E^s_{k,i} \mathrel{+}= \sin\theta_k, \tag{10}$$

for $k = 0, \ldots, H{-}1$. Here n_i counts *touched* windows, not elapsed ones, and E^c, E^s record the phases at which the cell was touched. With the touched-window mean $\bar{o}_i = S_{0,i}/n_i$, the *centred* coefficients are $\alpha_k = 2(C_{k,i} - \bar{o}_i E^c_{k,i})/n_i$ and $\beta_k = 2(S_{k,i} - \bar{o}_i E^s_{k,i})/n_i$, i.e. $\alpha_k + \mathrm{i}\beta_k = \frac{2}{n_i}\sum_{w\in\mathcal{W}_i}(o_{i,w} - \bar{o}_i)\,e^{\mathrm{i}\theta_k}$ over the touched windows $\mathcal{W}_i$, the mean-removed spectrum of FreMEn. The harmonic amplitudes and the dominant amplitude are

$$a_{i,k} = \sqrt{\alpha_k^2 + \beta_k^2}, \qquad a_i = \begin{cases} 0, & n_i < T, \\ \max_{0\leq k<H} a_{i,k}, & n_i \geq T, \end{cases} \tag{11}$$

and the periodic predicate π_i, which adds a significance test to the amplitude threshold, is given in (13) below. The phase prediction $\hat{p}_i(w) = \operatorname{clip}_{[0,1]}\big(S_{0,i}/n_i + \sum_k [\alpha_k \cos((k{+}1)\omega w) + \beta_k \sin((k{+}1)\omega w)]\big)$

is exposed for downstream use. The gate $n_i \geq T$ withholds a harmonic estimate until a period's worth of touches exists; a sparsely observed cell needs T *touches*, which can span many more than T windows.

Remark 2 (Centring, and the defect it corrects). Centring bounds the amplitude by the occupancy variation. Since $|o_{i,w} - \bar{o}_i|$ averages $2\bar{o}_i(1-\bar{o}_i)$ over $\mathcal{W}_i$, the triangle inequality gives

$$a_i \;\leq\; 4\,\bar{o}_i(1-\bar{o}_i)$$

under any sampling of $\mathcal{W}_i$. A cell that is occupied (or free) in every touched window therefore has $a_i = 0$, and π_i with $a_{\min}$=0.3 requires $0.081 < \bar{o}_i < 0.919$: at least about 8% of its touched windows must be free. The code as first released (v0.1.0, commit `a82f935`; the package version string has not been raised since) omitted E^c, E^s, so its coefficients were uncentred. For an always-occupied cell, a_i was then twice the mean phase vector of $\mathcal{W}_i$: it measured *when* the cell was observed, not how its occupancy varied. For n consecutive touches this is

$$a_i = \max_{0\leq k<H} \frac{2\left|\sin\left(n(k{+}1)\pi/T\right)\right|}{n\left|\sin\left((k{+}1)\pi/T\right)\right|} \;\leq\; \frac{2}{n\sin(\pi/T)}.$$

It exceeds $a_{\min}$ at n = 10–13 for T=8 (peak 0.439 at n=11; the bound clears only from n=18), and at n = 29–40 for the shipped T=24, H=2 (bound: $n \geq 52$). Through the $\vee\,\pi_i$ term of (8), whose predicate was then $a_i \geq a_{\min}$ alone, a wall hit every window therefore left the Static layer for 120 integration ticks at L=10. Uneven phase coverage made this permanent: a wall seen in 8 of every 48 windows had $a_i \approx 1.66$. The corrected engine adds the two phase sums, 16 bytes per harmonic (the significance test below adds two more), and the per-cell cost order is unchanged. Ten regression tests cover both failures and genuine detection; seven of them fail on v0.1.0 and all pass after the fix (§5.1), and Table 6 compares E1–E3 before and after.

Calibrating the Periodic Test Against Noise. Centring removes the bias of the amplitude but not its variance, and $a_i \geq a_{\min}$ alone is not a test. If a cell's occupancy is pure noise, $o_{i,w} \sim \text{Bernoulli}(m)$ independently of the phase, each centred coefficient has variance $2m(1{-}m)/n_i$ under uniform phase coverage, a standard deviation of $\sqrt{0.5/8} = 0.25$ at $m{=}\frac{1}{2}$, $n_i{=}T{=}8$. A fixed $a_{\min}$ is then crossed by chance at short lengths, and pruning (§3.5) keeps returning cells to short lengths. We therefore test each harmonic for significance. Write $c_w = \cos\theta_k$, $s_w = \sin\theta_k$ over the touched windows, $\tilde{\mathbf{z}}_w = (c_w{-}\bar{c},\ s_w{-}\bar{s})^\top$ for the centred phase vectors, $\mathbf{y}_{i,k} = \sum_{w\in\mathcal{W}_i}(o_{i,w}-\bar{o}_i)\,\tilde{\mathbf{z}}_w = \frac{n_i}{2}(\alpha_k,\beta_k)^\top$ and $\mathbf{M}_{i,k} = \sum_w \tilde{\mathbf{z}}_w\tilde{\mathbf{z}}_w^\top$. Then

$$d_{i,k} = \mathbf{y}_{i,k}^\top \mathbf{M}_{i,k}^{-1}\mathbf{y}_{i,k}, \qquad B(r) = \begin{cases} 2r\,e^{1-2r}, & r > \frac{1}{2}, \\ 1, & r \leq \frac{1}{2}, \end{cases} \tag{12}$$

where $d_{i,k}$ is the drop in squared residual when a sinusoid at harmonic k is fitted with a floating mean, the generalised Lomb–Scargle periodogram (Zechmeister and Kürster, 2009). $\mathbf{M}_{i,k}$ needs two more accumulators per harmonic, $\sum\cos 2\theta_k$ and $\sum\sin 2\theta_k$, since $\sum c_w^2 = \frac{1}{2}(n_i + \sum\cos 2\theta_k)$ and $\sum c_w s_w = \frac{1}{2}\sum\sin 2\theta_k$. The periodic predicate requires, for some harmonic, both an effect size and significance at a nominal level δ (`periodic_false_alarm`):

$$\pi_i = \texttt{enable_periodicity} \wedge n_i \geq T \wedge \exists k:\ \left[a_{i,k} \geq a_{\min}\ \wedge\ H\,B(d_{i,k}) \leq \delta\right]. \tag{13}$$

Proposition 3 bounds the false-alarm probability of this predicate. It is an application of known results, not a new inequality: the moment-generating-function step is the bound of Hsu et al. (2012, Remark 2) for a quadratic form of a sub-Gaussian vector, here with the identity matrix and Hoeffding's variance proxy $\frac{1}{4}$, and the rest is Markov's inequality and a union bound over the harmonics. We state it with the explicit constants that the shipped test uses.

Proposition 3 (Calibrated false-alarm bound)**.** *Let the touched windows $\mathcal{W}_i$ ($|\mathcal{W}_i| = n$) be fixed independently of the occupancy, and let $o_{i,w}$, $w \in \mathcal{W}_i$, be independent* Bernoulli(m) *for one unknown $m \in [0,1]$. If $\mathbf{M}_{i,k}$ is non-singular, then $\Pr(d_{i,k} \geq r) \leq B(r)$ for every $r > 0$. Consequently, for every $a_{\min} \geq 0$ and $0 < \delta < H$, the predicate (13) is true with probability at most δ.*

Proof. Because $\sum_w \tilde{\mathbf{z}}_w = \mathbf{0}$, the unknown mean drops out: $\mathbf{y}_{i,k} = \sum_w \xi_w \tilde{\mathbf{z}}_w$ with $\xi_w = o_{i,w} - m$. Put $\mathbf{b}_w = \mathbf{M}_{i,k}^{-1/2}\tilde{\mathbf{z}}_w$ and $\mathbf{u} = \sum_w \xi_w \mathbf{b}_w$, so that $d_{i,k} = \|\mathbf{u}\|^2$ and $\sum_w \mathbf{b}_w \mathbf{b}_w^\top = \mathbf{I}_2$. Each ξ_w has mean zero and lies in an interval of length 1, so Hoeffding's lemma (Hoeffding, 1963) gives $\mathbb{E}\, e^{t\xi_w} \leq e^{t^2/8}$, and by independence $\mathbb{E}\, e^{\mathbf{v}^\top \mathbf{u}} \leq \exp\left(\frac{1}{8}\sum_w (\mathbf{v}^\top \mathbf{b}_w)^2\right) = e^{\|\mathbf{v}\|^2/8}$ for every $\mathbf{v} \in \mathbb{R}^2$. Following Hsu et al. (2012), let $\mathbf{g} \sim \mathcal{N}(\mathbf{0}, \mathbf{I}_2)$ be independent of $\mathbf{u}$. For $0 \leq \eta < 2$, $\mathbb{E}_{\mathbf{g}}\, e^{\sqrt{2\eta}\,\mathbf{g}^\top \mathbf{u}} = e^{\eta\|\mathbf{u}\|^2}$, so exchanging the expectations,

$$\mathbb{E}\, e^{\eta d_{i,k}} = \mathbb{E}_{\mathbf{g}}\, \mathbb{E}_{\mathbf{u}}\, e^{\sqrt{2\eta}\,\mathbf{g}^\top \mathbf{u}} \leq \mathbb{E}_{\mathbf{g}}\, e^{\eta\|\mathbf{g}\|^2/4} = (1 - \eta/2)^{-1}.$$

Markov's inequality gives $\Pr(d_{i,k} \geq r) \leq (1-\eta/2)^{-1} e^{-\eta r}$, and $\eta = 2 - 1/r$ (admissible for $r > \frac{1}{2}$) yields $2r\, e^{1-2r}$; for $r \leq \frac{1}{2}$ the bound 1 is trivial. B decreases strictly from 1 to 0 on $(\frac{1}{2}, \infty)$, so $H\, B(d_{i,k}) \leq \delta$ holds exactly when $d_{i,k} \geq r^\star$ with $B(r^\star) = \delta/H$. The union bound over the H harmonics then gives $\Pr(\pi_i) \leq H \cdot \delta/H = \delta$. □

The bound needs no knowledge of m: the sub-Gaussian constant $\frac{1}{4}$ is the Bernoulli worst case $m = \frac{1}{2}$. When $\mathbf{M}_{i,k}$ is singular (for instance at a Nyquist harmonic), the code projects onto its range; the same argument with a one-dimensional $\mathbf{g}$ gives the smaller bound $(1-\eta/2)^{-1/2} e^{-\eta r}$, so B stays valid. Under uniform phase coverage at a harmonic with $2(k{+}1) \not\equiv 0 \pmod{T}$ (so that the sine column does not vanish; the defaults $T/H \in \{8/3, 24/2\}$ satisfy it) $\mathbf{M}_{i,k} = \frac{n}{2}\mathbf{I}_2$ and $d_{i,k} = n\, a_{i,k}^2/2$, so (13) becomes an amplitude threshold that shrinks with n,

$$a_{i,k} \;\geq\; \max\left(a_{\min},\; a^\star(n)\right), \qquad a^\star(n) = \sqrt{2r^\star/n}. \tag{14}$$

For δ=0.1 and H=3, $r^\star = 3.115$, so $a^\star(8) = 0.883$ and $a^\star(64) = 0.312$. The bound is conservative: in the Gaussian limit at m=$\frac{1}{2}$, $\Pr(d_{i,k} \geq r) \to e^{-2r}$, a factor $2e\,r$ below $B(r)$, or about 17 at $r^\star$. We therefore first treated δ as a nominal level for one read-out and chose it on a calibration set disjoint from every evaluation seed (E0, §5.1). The pre-stated rule took the largest $\delta \in \{0.01, 0.02, 0.05, 0.1, 0.2\}$ whose measured per-read-out false-alarm rate stays at or below 0.01, both over a null grid and in the live pipeline, and it selected δ=0.1 (Table 7). That rule compares point estimates: the worst pipeline rate at δ=0.1, 7 of 1000 cells, has a 95% Wilson upper limit of 0.0144 (Wilson, 1927), so the calibration does not establish the 0.01 target with confidence. Only δ is held out; the test itself was introduced after the amplitude-only rule produced false positives on the E2 seed, so E2 is not a blind evaluation of its design. More importantly, one read-out is not what the map does.

Spending the Level Over Repeated Read-Outs. The map evaluates (13) after every window, so a clutter cell gets one chance per read-out, and pruning (16) erases its history and starts another. E5 measures the consequence: at a single-read-out level of 0.1, up to 953 of 2000 Bernoulli clutter cells are labelled Periodic at some window within 1024 windows (§5.3). The shipped rule therefore replaces the constant level δ in (13) by a level that decreases with the touch count,

$$\delta_n = \delta\, \frac{T}{n(n+1)} \quad (n \geq T), \qquad \sum_{n \geq T} \delta_n = \delta, \tag{15}$$

where the sum telescopes because $T/(n(n{+}1)) = T/n - T/(n{+}1)$. This is a Bonferroni-type allocation of the level over the sequence of read-outs, in the spirit of the alpha-spending functions used for repeated significance tests in group-sequential trials (Lan and DeMets, 1983); Proposition 4 is the union bound over it.

Proposition 4 (Trajectory-level false-alarm bound)**.** *Call a* history *of cell i its touched windows from its creation until it is pruned or the run ends. Suppose that, given everything observed before the history begins, its touched windows are fixed independently of its occupancy and its occupancy samples are independent* Bernoulli(m)*. With the level δ_n of* (15) *in* (13)*, the probability that π_i holds at some read-out of the history is at most δ, whatever the length of the run. If L_N histories of the cell begin in windows $1, \dots, N$, the probability that the cell is labelled Periodic at some window up to N is at most $\delta\,\mathbb{E}[L_N]$.*

Proof. Condition on everything observed before the history begins; under the hypothesis the history is then a fixed-design sample. For $n \geq T$ let D_n be the event that the statistic of its first n samples, computed as if the cell were never pruned, satisfies (13) at level δ_n. Proposition 3 with δ_n in place of δ gives $\Pr(D_n) \leq \delta_n$. A read-out at touch count n evaluates π_i on exactly these n samples (read-outs between two touches repeat the last value), and it happens only if the history survived to n, so the event that π_i ever holds is contained in $\bigcup_{n \geq T} D_n$. The union bound gives at most $\sum_{n \geq T} \delta_n = \delta$; pruning only removes read-outs. For the second claim, the ℓ-th history begins at a window determined by the past, so the probability that it begins by N and fires is at most δ times the probability that it begins by N; summing over ℓ gives $\delta\,\mathbb{E}[L_N]$. □

The proposition is strongest where pruning does not act. A graduated cell is exempt from (16), so while a wall stays Static its history is not interrupted, and the probability that the $\vee\,\pi_i$ term of (8) ever demotes it on iid noise during that history is at most δ. A noisy wall can still be demoted through the occupancy disjunct, pruned and re-created (Bernoulli(0.6) cells begin 5 histories in 1024 windows under the E2 parameters, Table 32), so over a whole run the bound for a wall is $\delta\,\mathbb{E}[L_N]$ as well. For clutter that is pruned and re-created, the bound grows with the number of histories, which depends on the data: a Bernoulli(0.4) cell under the E2 parameters begins about 62 histories in 1024 windows, and $\delta\,\mathbb{E}[L_N]$ is then vacuous. That regime is measured (E5), not guaranteed. The null is still that of Proposition 3: temporally correlated clutter violates it, and E5 shows that the test flags such clutter. The shipped level is chosen on separate calibration seeds, now at trajectory level. The pre-stated rule takes the largest $\delta \in \{0.01, 0.02, 0.05, 0.1, 0.2\}$ for which the rate of ever labelling a Bernoulli clutter cell Periodic within 1024 windows has a Wilson 95% upper limit (Wilson, 1927) of at most 0.01 in every calibration configuration. It selects δ=0.2, the largest candidate (Table 9), and this is the shipped default. For the shipped rule, then, what is proved is the per-history bound 0.2; the 0.01 target is a measurement. Under uniform coverage the threshold of (14) becomes $a^\star(n) = \sqrt{2r_n^\star/n}$ with $B(r_n^\star) = \delta_n/H$, which falls roughly like $\sqrt{\log n/n}$ rather than $1/\sqrt{n}$. The detection delay is the price: in E2 a 50%-duty door with T=8 is detected from 25 windows, against 15 with a single-read-out level of 0.1 and 8 without the test.

3.5. Classifying and Pruning: Four Classes from One State

At the end of the same per-cell pass, a cell with little evidence is erased together with its Fourier accumulators:

$$\text{erase } i \iff \neg g_i \wedge p_i < p_{\text{prune}} \wedge a_i < a_{\min}. \tag{16}$$

Static cells and periodic cells are therefore never pruned. The guard uses the lenient effect-size screen $a_i < a_{\min}$ rather than $\neg\pi_i$, so a *candidate* periodic cell keeps its accumulators, and hence its growing n_i, until the test resolves it. Every other erased cell loses $\boldsymbol{\phi}_i$. We considered keeping the Fourier history of erased cells and rejected it: pruning exists so that clutter does not accumulate, and a record for every cell ever touched would grow without bound, fastest in `voxel3d`, where every sampled free voxel is a cell. A re-created cell restarts at $n_i = 0$ with a new history and, under (15), a new level

Algorithm 1: `endWindow` for `evidence_model = legacy`: one layered update per closed window, as in `layered_map.cpp` (Algorithm 2 is the sequential model)

Input: live cells $\mathcal{X}$ with window counters h_i, m_i; window index w

$w \leftarrow w + 1$;
foreach *live cell* i **do**
  $\tau \leftarrow [h_i{>}0 \vee m_i{>}0]$, $o \leftarrow [h_i{>}0]$, $f \leftarrow [h_i{=}0 \wedge m_i{>}0]$; // Eq. (5)
  if τ **then**
    $\ell_i \leftarrow \mathrm{clamp}\big(\lambda(\ell_i + o\, l_{\mathrm{hit}} + f\, l_{\mathrm{miss}}),\, l_{\min},\, l_{\max}\big)$, $N_i \leftarrow N_i + 1$; // Eq. (6)
    if `enable_periodicity` **then** update $\boldsymbol{\phi}_i$ with (o, w) // Eq. (10);
  $p_i \leftarrow \sigma(\ell_i)$, $a_i \leftarrow \mathrm{amplitude}(\boldsymbol{\phi}_i)$, $\pi_i \leftarrow$ Eq. (13) on $\boldsymbol{\phi}_i$; // Eqs. (11)–(13)
  if $\neg g_i \wedge \neg\pi_i \wedge p_i \geq p_{\mathrm{grad}} \wedge N_i \geq N_{\min}$ **then** $g_i \leftarrow$ true // Eq. (7);
  if $g_i \wedge (p_i \leq p_{\mathrm{dem}} \vee \pi_i)$ **then** $g_i \leftarrow$ false // Eq. (8);
  $h_i \leftarrow 0$, $m_i \leftarrow 0$;
  if $\neg g_i \wedge p_i < p_{\mathrm{prune}} \wedge a_i < a_{\min}$ **then** erase i and $\boldsymbol{\phi}_i$ // Eq. (16);

Output: updated $\mathcal{X}$; classes by Eq. (17) on demand

budget; this is why the trajectory bound of Proposition 4 scales with the number of histories. The read-out Ψ of (1) is a priority ladder,

$$c_i = \begin{cases} \mathsf{U} & i \text{ absent}, \\ \mathsf{S} & g_i, \\ \mathsf{P} & \pi_i, \\ \mathsf{T} & p_i \geq p_{\mathrm{prune}}, \\ \mathsf{U} & \text{otherwise}, \end{cases} \tag{17}$$

evaluated top to bottom. In the sequential model Static and Periodic keep their places; below them an undecided cell is Transient, or Intermittent once it has $n_{\max}$ touched windows, and a rejected cell that is kept only as a periodic candidate reads Unknown (Section 4.3). The node renders it with the convention Unknown −1, free 0, Transient 50, Periodic 75, Static 100, writing in ascending priority so Static wins any tie: `grid2d` keeps one byte per cell outside the classifier, an observed-free bit set by the ray clear and never cleared, a bit for a hit in the open window and a bit for whether the cell's last observation was a hit; it draws 50 for a cell hit in the open window or last observed as a hit, or a Transient cell whose evidence leans occupied ($p_i > 0.5$), and 0 for a cleared cell last observed free, so free means last observed free; `voxel3d` publishes only Static voxel centres. Table 29 lists every transition. The update visits every live cell, including untouched ones, because (7)–(16) read the recomputed p_i and a_i; its cost per window is linear in the number of live cells times H, and between window closes a sweep costs $O(1)$ per endpoint plus the ray walk. Per-cell state is a 24-byte record plus roughly 32 bytes of hash-node overhead, the ~56 B/cell used in §5. That figure is an estimate for the periodicity-off path, not a measurement. A Fourier record, with two scalar accumulators and six heap-allocated vectors of H values in a second hash map, is allocated only for cells touched with periodicity enabled and is not included in it, nor are the hash tables' bucket arrays or the `grid2d` flag byte per grid cell with its list of cells touched in the open window.

3.6. Selecting a Backend: One Interface, One String

`MapBackend` exposes five methods: `integrate(obs, origin)` runs Γ_b for one sweep, `tick()` advances the integration counter and may close a window, `closeWindows(k)` closes k windows at

once for the time-based rule of §3.2, and two read-only counters report Static and Transient cells. The node reads one string parameter, `backend` ∈ {`grid2d`, `voxel3d`}, holds one `unique_ptr` per concrete backend and instantiates exactly one at construction (the string is not validated: any value other than `grid2d` selects `voxel3d`); all engine parameters are read through one shared helper, so the tuning surface is backend-independent by construction. At two backends a runtime `dlopen` registry such as `pluginlib` (Open Robotics, 2024) would add discovery machinery whose cost is not yet repaid. Because Φ and Ψ in (1) never see coordinates, any behavioural or cost difference between the backends must originate in κ_b, ρ_b or their input sampling—the property the experiments test.

3.7. Reconciling Code and Specification

We document the code that ships. Two places diverge from the design document (`SPEC.md`), and each changes operational semantics.

Remark 3 (Forgetting is coupled to re-observation). The design document states that every cell decays every window. In the code, (6) runs only for touched cells, so a cell outside the sensor's field of view neither decays nor relaxes toward the prior: its ℓ_i freezes. Clutter fades only while it is re-observed as free, and anything that leaves the field of view persists (§8).

Remark 4 (The amplitude gate counts touches). The design document gates the amplitude on *elapsed* windows; the code gates on the touched-window count n_i of (13). This is the mechanism behind the low-duty-cycle miss in §5.2.

4. Evidence as a Sequential Test

For each cell, STRATA decides between two stories: its occupancy is clutter, or it is structure. The state of that decision is one number, the log-odds ℓ of Eq. (6). This section shows what that number is a test of, why the leak of Eq. (6) removes the property on which an error bound rests, and how engine version 0.2 replaces the rule of the first release with a test whose hypotheses and error rates the user states. The first release is still in the code as `evidence_model = legacy`; the experiments run both. Every number of this section that comes from a run is generated from the committed results (Appendix A).

4.1. The v0.1 increments are a sequential probability ratio test

Let a cell be touched in a sequence of windows, and let $x_t \in \{0, 1\}$ record whether window t held a hit ($x_t = 1$) or only misses ($x_t = 0$). Let m be the probability of a hit in a touched window, the *hit rate* of the cell. Wald's sequential probability ratio test (SPRT) (Wald, 1947) of $H_0 : m = m_0$ (clutter) against $H_1 : m = m_1$ (structure), with $m_0 < m_1$, adds the log-likelihood ratio of each observation to a statistic,

$$\ell_t = \ell_{t-1} + \begin{cases} \ln \dfrac{m_1}{m_0}, & x_t = 1, \\ \ln \dfrac{1 - m_1}{1 - m_0}, & x_t = 0, \end{cases} \qquad \ell_0 = 0, \tag{18}$$

decides for H_1 when $\ell_t \geq A$, for H_0 when $\ell_t \leq B$, and otherwise takes one more observation. For the error rates α (decide H_1 under H_0) and β (decide H_0 under H_1), Wald's thresholds are $A = \ln \frac{1-\beta}{\alpha}$ and $B = \ln \frac{\beta}{1-\alpha}$. Compare Eq. (18) with Eq. (6): the first release adds l_{hit} in a hit window and l_{miss} in a miss window. The two pairs of increments determine each other.

Proposition 5 (Increments determine the hypotheses)**.** *For every $l_{\text{hit}} > 0 > l_{\text{miss}}$ there is exactly one pair $0 < m_0 < m_1 < 1$ with $\ln(m_1/m_0) = l_{\text{hit}}$ and $\ln\big((1-m_1)/(1-m_0)\big) = l_{\text{miss}}$, namely*

$$m_0 = \frac{1 - e^{l_{\text{miss}}}}{e^{l_{\text{hit}}} - e^{l_{\text{miss}}}}, \qquad m_1 = m_0\, e^{l_{\text{hit}}}. \tag{19}$$

Proof. The two conditions read $m_1 = m_0 e^{l_{\text{hit}}}$ and $1 - m_1 = (1 - m_0)e^{l_{\text{miss}}}$. Substituting the first into the second gives $m_0\,(e^{l_{\text{hit}}} - e^{l_{\text{miss}}}) = 1 - e^{l_{\text{miss}}}$, which is Eq. (19). Since $l_{\text{miss}} < 0 < l_{\text{hit}}$, the numerator and the denominator are positive, so $m_0 > 0$, and $m_1 > m_0$ follows from $l_{\text{hit}} > 0$. Finally $m_1 < 1$ is equivalent to $e^{l_{\text{miss}}} < e^{l_{\text{hit}}+l_{\text{miss}}}$, which holds because $l_{\text{hit}} > 0$. □

The shipped values of the first release are the sensor model of OctoMap, $l_{\text{hit}} = 0.85$ and $l_{\text{miss}} = -0.4$ (Hornung et al., 2013), which the engine applies once per touched window. By Eq. (19) they are the increments of an SPRT between the hit rates $m_0 = 0.1975$ and $m_1 = 0.4621$. The graduation probability p_{grad}=0.8 is the threshold $A = \operatorname{logit} p_{\text{grad}} = 1.386$, and without the leak a cell with the hit rate $m^* = -l_{\text{miss}}/(l_{\text{hit}} - l_{\text{miss}}) = 0.32$ has zero drift. In the first release of STRATA these hypotheses were not chosen; the two increments imply them. In this reading Static means that the evidence favours a hit rate near 0.4621 over one near 0.1975 by a factor of four, and a cell whose hit rate is above m^* drifts toward Static. This is the reason for the false Static labels that E6 measures (Remark 1 gives the same threshold in the form that includes the leak).

4.2. A leak breaks the premise of the error bound

An error statement for a sequential test rests on the fact that e^{ℓ_t} is a nonnegative supermartingale when H_0 is true. Then Ville's maximal inequality bounds the probability that the statistic ever reaches a threshold (Howard et al., 2020, Lemma 1); Howard et al. (2020, Section 4.6) state that this is an open-ended SPRT with a valid type-I error. The recursion of the first release, $\ell \leftarrow \lambda(\ell + x)$ with $\lambda = 0.97$, breaks the property.

Proposition 6 (A leak breaks the supermartingale)**.** *Let $Z = \ln(m_1/m_0)$ with probability m_0 and $Z = \ln\frac{1-m_1}{1-m_0}$ otherwise, so that $\mathbb{E}\,e^Z = 1$. For $\lambda \in (0,1)$ and a level $\ell < 0$, the leaky update $\ell' = \lambda(\ell + Z)$ satisfies*

$$\frac{\mathbb{E}\,e^{\ell'}}{e^{\ell}} = e^{(1-\lambda)|\ell|}\,\mathbb{E}\,e^{\lambda Z},$$

and this ratio exceeds 1 for every $|\ell| > \ln\big(1/\mathbb{E}\,e^{\lambda Z}\big)/(1-\lambda)$. Hence e^{ℓ_t} is not a supermartingale under H_0.

Proof. $\mathbb{E}\,e^{\lambda(\ell+Z)} = e^{\lambda\ell}\,\mathbb{E}\,e^{\lambda Z}$, and $e^{\lambda\ell}/e^{\ell} = e^{(1-\lambda)|\ell|}$ for $\ell < 0$. The factor $\mathbb{E}\,e^{\lambda Z}$ is a positive constant, so the product grows without bound in $|\ell|$. □

At the values of the first release ($\lambda = 0.97$, increments $(0.85, -0.4)$, hit rate $m_0 = 0.1975$) the ratio at the level $\ell = -4$ is 1.12, and the level lies inside the clamp $[-5, 5]$ of Table 25. The leak is also what moves the zero-drift rate from 0.32 to the value of Remark 1. We found no result that gives error rates for a Wald test with a multiplicative leak; leaky accumulators are studied as models of decision making (Bogacz et al., 2006), not as tests with a stated error. Where forgetting is wanted, version 0.2 provides it by a separate mechanism (the ceiling and the reverse test below), not by shrinking the statistic.

Table 1: Quantities derived from the shipped pair $(m_0, m_1, \alpha, \beta) = (0.20, 0.70, 0.01, 0.01)$ (generated from the library defaults by the rule of the engine). Windows are touched windows. *Always-hit*: windows an always-hit cell needs to graduate; *demote*: all-miss windows that demote a graduated cell.

l_{hit}	l_{miss}	$A = -B$	$\ell_{\max}$	m^*	Always-hit	Demote	T	$n_{\max}$
1.2528	−0.9808	4.5951	7.1006	0.4391	4	5	24	80

4.3. The test of engine version 0.2

What the user states. The user states two hit rates and two error rates: m_0, the hit rate at or below which a cell is clutter; m_1, the hit rate at or above which it is structure; α, the probability that clutter at m_0 is declared Static; β, the probability that structure at m_1 is rejected. The engine requires $0 < m_0 < m_1 < 1$, $\alpha, \beta > 0$ and $\alpha + \beta < 1$, and derives

$$l_{\text{hit}} = \ln \frac{m_1}{m_0}, \qquad l_{\text{miss}} = \ln \frac{1 - m_1}{1 - m_0},$$
$$A = \ln \frac{1 - \beta}{\alpha}, \qquad B = \ln \frac{\beta}{1 - \alpha}, \qquad \ell_{\max} = A + 2l_{\text{hit}}. \tag{20}$$

Nothing is tuned by hand. The shipped values are $(m_0, m_1, \alpha, \beta) = (0.20, 0.70, 0.01, 0.01)$. They are *provisional*: they are the pair measured on one calibration set, whose quality gate failed (Section 6), and the node says so on its diagnostics topic. Table 1 lists what Eq. (20) gives for them.

Three outcomes. For each touched window the statistic moves by l_{hit} (a hit) or l_{miss} (only misses), with no multiplier, and is capped at $\ell_{\max}$. A cell ends in one of three states:

- *Static*: $\ell \geq A$ and the cell is not Periodic. The cell graduates and its statistic restarts at the cap $\ell_{\max}$.
- *Rejected*: $n \geq T$ touched windows and $\ell \leq B$. The cell is erased, and the next observation starts a new history. A cell that is rejected while its amplitude is still at least $a_{\min}$ is kept as a periodic candidate with ℓ held at B until the periodicity test resolves it.
- *Undecided*: everything else. Undecided cells are reported as such. They are never promoted by a timer, and the engine reports their number and its memory cost.

The *periodicity gate* $n \geq T$ closes the prune/maturity race of Proposition 8: a cell cannot be rejected, and its statistic is not bounded below, before it has T touches for the periodicity test to read. The price is that a clutter cell lives at least T touched windows before it is erased (Table 3). The Periodic veto is unchanged from Section 3.4: a cell for which π_i holds does not graduate and is demoted if it is Static.

Demotion is a reverse test. A graduated cell sits at the cap. It is demoted when $\ell \leq \ell_{\max} - A$, that is, after $\lceil A/|l_{\text{miss}}| \rceil = 5$ all-miss windows at the shipped pair; one miss never demotes. This is the SPRT in the opposite direction with the same error rates. After a demotion the forward test restarts from $\ell = 0$ and $n = 0$.

Truncation. An undecided cell that is not Periodic is read out as *Intermittent* once it has $n_{\max}$ touched windows ($n_{\max}$=80, the smallest multiple of 16 for which at most 3% of cells at the zero-drift rate m^* are still undecided; the rule is pre-registered in Section 6). Intermittent is a read-out only: the test keeps running, and the cell can still graduate or be rejected. The 2D grid renders it like Transient. The occupancy probability that the engine publishes is $\sigma(\ell)$, the posterior probability of "structure" for equal priors on the two hypotheses; it is not a calibrated occupancy.

Algorithm 2: `endWindow` for `evidence_model = sprt`, as in `layered_map.cpp`

Input: live cells $\mathcal{X}$ with window counters; derived $l_{\text{hit}}, l_{\text{miss}}, A, B, \ell_{\max}$; gate T

foreach *live cell* i **do**
- **if** i *was touched* **then**
  - $\ell_i \leftarrow \min\left(\ell_i + o_i\, l_{\text{hit}} + f_i\, l_{\text{miss}},\ \ell_{\max}\right)$, $n_i \leftarrow n_i + 1$; `// Eq. (5)`
  - **if** $n_i \geq T$ **then** $\ell_i \leftarrow \max(\ell_i, B)$;
  - update the Fourier model $\boldsymbol{\phi}_i$ with (o_i, w) and recompute π_i;
- **if** $\neg g_i \wedge \neg\pi_i \wedge \ell_i \geq A$ **then**
  - $g_i \leftarrow$ true, $\ell_i \leftarrow \ell_{\max}$; `// graduate`
- **if** g_i **then**
  - **if** π_i **then** $g_i \leftarrow$ false;
  - **else if** $\ell_i \leq \ell_{\max} - A$ **then** $g_i \leftarrow$ false, $\ell_i \leftarrow 0$, $n_i \leftarrow 0$;
- **if** $\neg g_i \wedge n_i \geq T \wedge \ell_i \leq B \wedge a_i < a_{\min}$ **then** erase i and $\boldsymbol{\phi}_i$ `// rejected`;

Output: classes: Static if g_i; Periodic if π_i; otherwise Unknown if rejected and kept, Intermittent if $n_i \geq n_{\max}$, else Transient

4.4. What the error rates promise

Proposition 7 (Error bounds under independent windows)**.** *Call a* history *of a cell its touched windows from its creation until it is erased or the run ends. Suppose that, given everything observed before the history begins, its touched windows are fixed independently of its occupancy and its outcomes $x_1, x_2, \ldots$ are independent Bernoulli(p). If $p \leq m_0$, the probability that the history ever graduates by the test is at most $e^{-A} = \alpha/(1-\beta)$. If $p \geq m_1$, the probability that the history is rejected is at most $e^{B} = \beta/(1-\alpha)$. If L_N histories of a cell begin in windows $1, \ldots, N$, the probability that the cell is Static at some window up to N for a clutter rate $p \leq m_0$ is at most $e^{-A}\,\mathbb{E}[L_N]$.*

Proof. Let $\lambda(1) = m_1/m_0$ and $\lambda(0) = (1-m_1)/(1-m_0)$ and $\Lambda_t = \prod_{s\leq t} \lambda(x_s)$, so that $\ell_t = \ln \Lambda_t$ while no clamp has acted. A direct computation gives

$$\mathbb{E}_p\, \lambda(x) = 1 + \frac{(p-m_0)(m_1-m_0)}{m_0(1-m_0)} \leq 1 \quad (p \leq m_0),$$
$$\mathbb{E}_p\, \frac{1}{\lambda(x)} = 1 + \frac{(p-m_1)(m_0-m_1)}{m_1(1-m_1)} \leq 1 \quad (p \geq m_1).$$

Hence for $p \leq m_0$ the process Λ_t is a nonnegative supermartingale with $\Lambda_0 = 1$, and Ville's inequality (Howard et al., 2020, Lemma 1) gives $\Pr(\sup_t \Lambda_t \geq e^A) \leq e^{-A}$. Up to the first time the statistic reaches A the cap $\ell_{\max} > A + l_{\text{hit}}$ does not act; no rejection precedes the periodicity gate and a rejection ends the history, so up to the end of the history the engine's statistic equals $\ln \Lambda_t$ (a rejected periodic candidate is a continuation of the cell that the proposition does not cover). The event that the history graduates is contained in $\{\sup_t \Lambda_t \geq e^A\}$; the Periodic veto only removes graduations. For $p \geq m_1$ the process $1/\Lambda_t$ is a supermartingale and the event that the history is rejected is contained in $\{\sup_t \Lambda_t^{-1} \geq e^{-B}\}$. The third statement follows as in Proposition 4: the ℓ-th history begins at a window determined by the past. □

Four limits of this statement matter for how the numbers of Section 7 are read.

- *The unit is the history.* The bound is per history. A rejected cell is erased and its next hit starts a new history with a new chance to graduate, so the share of cells that are ever Static in a run can

Table 2: The guarantee needs independent windows (E7). Share of cell histories that ever graduate when the windows of a cell at exactly m_0 follow a two-state chain with lag-1 autocorrelation ρ ($\rho = 0$: independent). *Engine*: per history, 1024 windows, shipped pair. *Bare walk*: a random walk floored at B and never rejected, 200 windows, the shipped pair; this is not the engine. Ratios are to α=0.01. The band means of the lag-1 autocorrelation of the window outcomes of real LILocBench calibration cells lie between 0.231 and 0.474 (Table 18).

ρ	Engine, share	Engine, ratio	Bare walk, share	Bare walk, ratio
0	0.556 %	0.56	0.943 %	0.94
0.1	1.358 %	1.36	3.537 %	3.54
0.23	3.492 %	3.49	12.298 %	12.30
0.35	6.089 %	6.09	28.109 %	28.11
0.5	10.870 %	10.87	55.028 %	55.03

exceed the per-history bound (Proposition 7 bounds it by the bound times the expected number of histories). The per-cell rates on real clutter are reported in Section 7 and are above α.

- *Independence is an assumption.* Real windows of one cell are correlated. Table 2 measures the effect on the engine for a cell at exactly m_0: the share of histories that graduate within 1024 windows is 0.556 % for independent windows, 3.492 % at lag-1 autocorrelation 0.23 (3.49 times α) and 10.870 % at 0.5. A bare random walk floored at B and never rejected, which is not the engine, reaches 12.30 times α at 0.23. The band means of the lag-1 autocorrelation of real LILocBench calibration cells lie between 0.231 and 0.474 (Table 18), so independence does not hold, and no guarantee of the paper is stated for real windows.
- *Nothing is promised between the hypotheses.* A cell with a hit rate between m_0 and m_1 is neither clutter nor structure in the test, and it graduates with the probability of the operating characteristic below. The sweep of Table 3 shows how steeply that probability rises between m_0 and m_1.
- *A hit rate cannot say which kind of object produced it.* A wall seen in 60 % of its windows and clutter present in 60 % are the same input for this test. A pre-registered rule named a second statistic (run lengths) as a third step. Its trigger fired on the calibration data with opposite signs in the two datasets that it was read on (Section 6); we did not implement it, and the engine of this paper has no second statistic.

4.5. Operating characteristic and latency

For the hit rate m the probability that the test graduates a cell follows from Wald's operating characteristic, which neglects the overshoot of the statistic over the thresholds (Wald, 1947, Chapter 3). With $a = e^A$ and $b = e^B$,

$$P_m(\text{graduate}) \approx \frac{1 - b^h}{a^h - b^h}, \qquad m\left(\frac{m_1}{m_0}\right)^h + (1 - m)\left(\frac{1 - m_1}{1 - m_0}\right)^h = 1, \tag{21}$$

where $h = h(m) \neq 0$ solves the second equation, and the value at the zero-drift rate m^* ($h = 0$) is the limit $A/(A - B)$. The formula gives α at m_0 ($h = 1$) and $1 - \beta$ at m_1 ($h = -1$). Experiment E7 compares three quantities on the same pair: Monte Carlo on the real engine (40000 histories per rate), the exact value of the same rule computed state by state on the lattice $\ell = h\, l_{\text{hit}} + k\, l_{\text{miss}}$, and Eq. (21) (Table 3). The engine and the exact computation agree: the exact value lies inside the Wilson interval of the Monte Carlo share in 38 of 40 rows, and the mean number of windows to a decision differs by

Table 3: Operating characteristic of the sequential test on the engine (E7), pair $(m_0, m_1, \alpha, \beta) = (0.20, 0.70, 0.01, 0.01)$, independent windows. P(Static): share of 40000 cells per rate that graduate. *Engine*: Monte Carlo on `LayeredMap` with the periodicity gate T=24 (the shipped rule) and Wilson 95% limits; *Exact*: the same rule computed state by state on the lattice $l = h\, l_{\text{hit}} + k\, l_{\text{miss}}$, no sampling; *Wald*: the closed form of Eq. (21), which ignores the overshoot of the statistic over the thresholds. The last column is the mean number of windows to a decision (engine / exact).

m	Engine, P(Static)	Exact	Wald	Windows
0.05	0.0000 [0.0000, 0.0001]	0.0000	0.0000	24.0 / 24.0
0.10	0.0002 [0.0001, 0.0004]	0.0002	0.0004	24.0 / 24.0
0.15	0.0011 [0.0008, 0.0015]	0.0012	0.0026	24.0 / 24.0
0.20	0.0053 [0.0046, 0.0061]	0.0055	0.0100	24.1 / 24.1
0.25	0.0195 [0.0182, 0.0209]	0.0200	0.0306	24.5 / 24.5
0.30	0.0595 [0.0572, 0.0619]	0.0615	0.0794	25.5 / 25.4
0.35	0.1579 [0.1544, 0.1615]	0.1615	0.1782	27.1 / 27.1
0.40	0.3476 [0.3429, 0.3523]	0.3506	0.3409	28.4 / 28.3
0.4391 (m^*)	0.5481 [0.5432, 0.5530]	0.5462	0.5000	27.6 / 27.6
0.50	0.8166 [0.8128, 0.8204]	0.8166	0.7334	23.2 / 23.1
0.60	0.9844 [0.9831, 0.9856]	0.9838	0.9377	14.0 / 14.0
0.70	0.9997 [0.9995, 0.9998]	0.9996	0.9900	9.0 / 9.0
0.80	1.0000 [0.9999, 1.0000]	1.0000	0.9990	6.5 / 6.5

at most 0.16 windows. At m_0 the exact graduation probability is 0.0055, below both α and the Ville bound 0.0101, because the statistic overshoots the threshold. Eq. (21) departs from the exact value by at most 0.028 for the rule without a gate (at $m = 0.35$) and by at most 0.083 for the shipped rule with the periodicity gate (at $m = 0.50$); the gate keeps cells from being rejected early, which is why the shipped rule graduates 0.9996 of the cells at m_1 where the closed form says $1 - \beta$. A cell that is clutter lives 24.1 windows on average under the shipped rule ($T = 24$) against 9.1 without the gate.

The latency of an always-hit wall is a consequence of the error rates, not a free constant: it graduates at the window $\lceil A/l_{\text{hit}} \rceil = \lceil \ln \frac{1-\beta}{\alpha} / \ln \frac{m_1}{m_0} \rceil$, which is 4 at the shipped pair, not the third window of the first release. We report the latency; we do not advertise it. A graduated cell is demoted after $\lceil A/|l_{\text{miss}}| \rceil$ all-miss windows. Rejection waits for the T touched windows of the gate, so on a short pass a cell touched fewer than T times can end Static or Undecided but never Rejected; Section 7 reports the Undecided share on real data.

5. Synthetic Experiments

The synthetic suite uses hand-authored hit and miss patterns, so that the truth of every cell is known. It runs in two arms: the *legacy* arm, the arithmetic of the first release with the explicit parameters of the first release, whose results are those of the first version of this study; and the *sprt* arm, the sequential test at the shipped defaults on the same scenes and seeds (Section 5.5). In the text and tables of the legacy arm, *shipped* means the defaults of the first release (Table 25, legacy rows); in the sprt arm it means the defaults of version 0.2. We ask six questions. Do the two backends behave as one engine wearing two geometries (E1, E4)? Does the shared classifier detect periodic structure, and how does it fail (E2)? Does the live, pruned and repeatedly tested detector control false alarms over a whole run (E5)? Which cells does the graduation rule call Static when they are neither walls nor periodic (E5, E6)? Which mechanism actually stabilises the static layer (E3)? Does the sequential test on the real engine follow Wald's operating characteristic, and how much does autocorrelation of the windows inflate its error (E7)?

5.1. Experimental Setup

Harness and protocol. All experiments are driven by a standalone harness that compiles directly against the `strata_core` sources, with no ROS 2, ament or colcon in the loop; it lives in `paper/experiments/`. One command, `bashpaper/experiments/run_all.sh`, builds the core and its unit tests, checks the `ctest` suite (one target aggregating the 114 gtest cases, among them ten regression tests for the amplitude defect of Remark 2, nine for the significance test of Proposition 3 and eight for the spent level of Proposition 4), builds and runs the calibration E0 and the experiments E1–E6, and writes the CSVs in `paper/experiments/results/`; every table and plot in this paper is regenerated from those files (Appendix A). E0–E3, E5 and E6 reproduce their committed files byte for byte with GCC and libstdc++, and E1, one E0 file and E6's confusion change under another standard library (Appendix A); E4's timings are wall-clock and are recorded separately. Every stochastic experiment E1–E4 derives its `std::mt19937` generator from the constant seed 12345 plus a per-run offset recorded in code (offsets 0–1500), and the seed is logged in each CSV. The calibration E0 uses seeds from 20260928 upward, E5 draws its calibration seeds from 30260928 and its evaluation seeds from 40260928 upward, so no calibration stream coincides with an evaluation stream; E6 reuses the scene seeds of E5's confusion and draws its sweep from 50260928 upward, and the unit tests use a further disjoint range. E1–E4 magnitudes are single-seed point estimates: we report no cross-seed dispersion for them, and gaps such as 0.9253 against 0.9758 illustrate a mechanism rather than a distributional estimate. E5 and E6 are multi-seed and report Wilson 95% intervals.

What is compared. There is no external baseline in the synthetic suite. The lifelong-SLAM systems of §2 do not expose a persistence core that this harness could drive. The FreMEn per-cell model (Krajník et al., 2016, 2017; STRANDS Project, 2017), with its amplitude-ranked component selection, could be driven by the same streams, but we have not run it, so every comparison below is internal; the evaluation on real data (Section 7) compares four other evidence rules. The centred amplitude-only rule kept in Table 6 thresholds FreMEn-style coefficients at one fixed period; it is STRATA's own earlier rule, not an implementation of FreMEn. Instead E1 and E4 compare the two STRATA backends, each driven in its native geometry by its own seeded stream (`grid2d` on the integer lattice, `voxel3d` continuously); because both call the identical engine, any divergence arises in κ_b, ρ_b or their input sampling. E2 and E3 drive `LayeredMap` directly with no backend at all, which by (1) characterises the classifier for whichever backend supplies the ids. Each harness sets its own parameters in code (Table 26 for E1–E4; E0, E5 and E6 use the E2 parameters or the shipped defaults, as stated with each); in particular every experiment, E0 and E5 included, runs with one window per tick (L=1), so *window* and *frame* coincide.

Metrics. Static-set precision, recall and F1 against a known wall set (E1, E3); per-read-out false-alarm rates on pure-noise cells and the read-out length from which a door stays Periodic (E0); the trajectory-level false-alarm rate, i.e. the share of non-periodic cells labelled Periodic at *some* window up to a horizon N, the per-window labelling rate, and four-class precision and recall (E5); Periodic-class true- and false-positive rates against ground truth and the dominant amplitude a (E2); *flicker*, the number of per-window toggles of a wall cell's Static flag (E3); the share of Bernoulli(m) cells labelled Static (E6); final live-cell count, estimated memory at 56 B per cell and, where it was recorded reliably, latency per `integrate()` call (E4).

Scenarios and hardware. E0 runs first and fixes the single-read-out level (§3.4): iid Bernoulli(m) streams at $T/H \in \{8/3, 24/2\}$, $m \in \{0.05, 0.1, 0.2, \ldots, 0.9, 0.95\}$ and 12 read-out lengths $n \in \{8, \ldots, 100\}$ for T=8 and 8 lengths $n \in \{24, \ldots, 240\}$ for T=24 (listed in `e0_calibration.cpp`), with 20,000 streams per point; 3000 Bernoulli(m) clutter cells ($m \in \{0.3, 0.5, 0.7\}$) through the live `LayeredMap` with the E2 parameters, read out at every n = 8–100; and four doors (4-on/4-off, 2-on/2-off, 3-on/5-off, and 4-on/4-off with 10% flipped windows) in 40 runs each at random phase

offsets. E1: a 161-cell static cross (the segments y=60 and x=60 over [20, 100]) hit every window, plus 5, 25 or 100 fresh random movers per window, for 40 windows, on a 120×120 grid and a voxel map, both at resolution 1.0, once with periodicity off and once with it on at the shipped T=24, H=2. E2: three periodic doors (period 8 at 4-on/4-off and 2-on/6-off, period 4 at 2-on/2-off), a constant wall and four Bernoulli(0.5) aperiodic controls, with T=8, H=3, read out at 64 windows and, in a sweep, after every length n = 8–100 (a fresh map per length). E3: 50 wall cells observed occupied with probability 0.6 per window among 10 movers per window, 80 windows, the same noise replayed for all 36 configurations of $p_{\text{grad}} \in \{0.6, 0.7, 0.8, 0.9\} \times p_{\text{dem}} \in \{0.3, 0.5, p_{\text{grad}}\} \times \lambda \in \{0.90, 0.97, 1.0\}$, with periodicity off and again with it on at the shipped defaults. E5: Bernoulli(m) clutter, $m = 0.1, \ldots, 0.9$, plus always-occupied, always-free and temporally correlated cells (a two-state Markov chain with mean 0.5 and mean dwell 10 windows), 2000 cells per configuration (10 seeds of 200), through the live `LayeredMap` with the E2 and with the shipped parameters, touched every window or independently with probability q=0.5, over 1024 windows, labelled after every window; four door types for detection delay; and 20 E2-style scenes for the confusion of Table 11. The calibration half of E5 fixes the shipped level on its own seeds before the evaluation half runs. E6, added after E5 showed many false Static labels, repeats that confusion on the same 20 scene seeds under the E2 parameters with λ=0.97 and under the shipped defaults (whose doors have the same duty cycles at three times the period, since T=24), and sweeps Bernoulli(m) cells over $m = 0.05, 0.10, \ldots, 0.95$, 2000 cells per point (10 seeds of 200), touched every window for 256 windows, under four parameter sets: E2, E2 with λ=0.97, the shipped defaults, and the shipped defaults with $l_{\text{miss}} = -l_{\text{hit}}$. All E1–E4 results are from the current engine (centred coefficients and the test at δ=0.2 spent over the touch count). The same harness run against three earlier engines is kept for comparison (Table 6): v0.1.0, the centred engine with the amplitude-only rule $a \geq a_{\min}$, and the test at the single-read-out level δ=0.1. E4: 150 random hits per window for 20 windows at nominal extents 100^2, 250^2 and 500^2, resolution 1.0, periodicity off, each configuration run 15 times on a fresh map after one discarded warm-up run. E4 alone reads the wall clock. Timings are to be taken on a quiet host with `paper/experiments/measure_e4.sh`: the script refuses to start unless the 1-minute load average is below 0.50, pins the benchmark to one core, discards one warm-up run per configuration, records the load and the largest CPU consumers before and after, and marks a recording invalid when the load afterwards is 1.50 or more. No such recording exists, so we report no latency and no ratio. Its live-cell counts follow only from ray geometry and are deterministic.

5.2. Main Results

Summary of the legacy arm. Under the v0.1 evidence rule both backends graduate a 161-cell wall by the third window and keep recall at 1.0 through window 39 (with the sequential test of the current engine the same wall graduates at its derived fourth window and no false Static cell appears in any of the six runs); their only quality gap, a final static precision of 0.9253 (`grid2d`) against 0.9758 (`voxel3d`) under 100 movers per window, arises in the backends' native sampling rather than in the shared classifier. We report and correct two defects of the first release's periodicity test, with before-and-after results. An uncentred Fourier amplitude could demote constant walls. An uncalibrated amplitude threshold labelled Bernoulli clutter Periodic at 0 to 4 of 5 cells depending on read-out length, a mean false-positive rate of 0.331 even after centring. Because the map re-tests every window, a constant significance level still let up to 953 of 2000 clutter cells be labelled Periodic at some window of a 1024-window run; with the level spent over the touch count, at most 2 of 2000 are, on held-out seeds, and the E2 false-positive rate is 0 at every read-out length from 8 to 100 windows. Both 50%-duty doors are still detected, for a true-positive rate of 2/3, but only from 25 windows instead of 8, and the one miss is a provable interaction between pruning and the amplitude gate. Over 20 held-out scenes the dominant labelling error is a false Static label on aperiodic cells,

Table 4: Static-layer quality (E1) against the 161-cell ground-truth wall set. *Recall 1 from* is the first window index t at which recall reaches 1.0 (it never drops afterwards); precision, F1 and the predicted static-set size are at the final window t=39. Single seed (12345), so no dispersion is reported. Bold marks the better backend under high clutter.

Backend	Clutter (movers/window)	Recall 1 from	Precision	F1	$\lvert\hat{S}\rvert$
`grid2d`	low (5)	t=2	1.0000	1.0000	161
`grid2d`	med (25)	t=2	0.9938	0.9969	162
`grid2d`	high (100)	t=2	0.9253	0.9612	174
`voxel3d`	low (5)	t=2	1.0000	1.0000	161
`voxel3d`	med (25)	t=2	0.9938	0.9969	162
`voxel3d`	high (100)	t=2	**0.9758**	**0.9877**	165

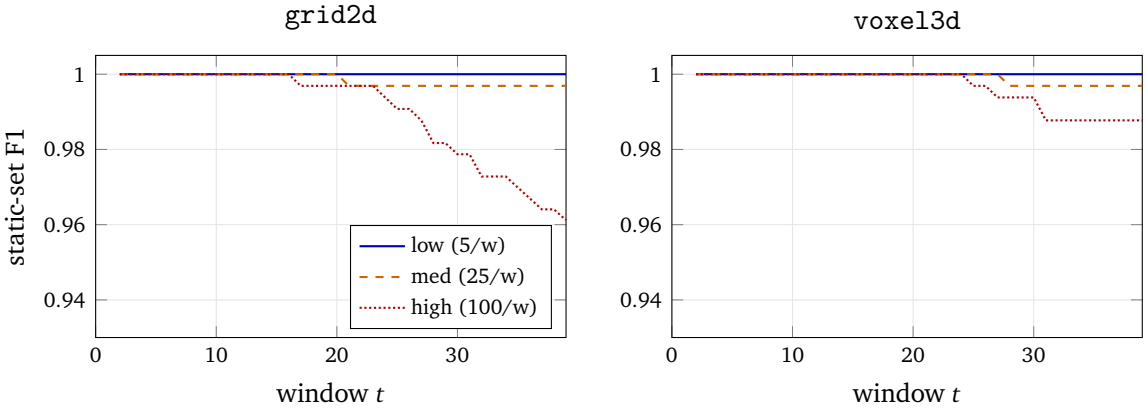


Figure 2: Static-layer F1 over time (E1). F1 is 0 for $t < 2$ (no cell has met $N_{\min}$=3; not shown) and reaches 1.0 at t=2 for every backend and clutter level. Only the 100-movers-per-window regime accumulates false statics, more so on `grid2d`. Plotted directly from `e1_static_quality.csv`.

not a false Periodic one: with the v0.1 defaults 1960 of 2000 Bernoulli(0.5) cells end Static, and the graduation rule cannot separate such clutter from a noisy wall of similar occupancy (Remark 1; Section 4.1 gives the reason). Removing the hysteresis band raises flicker from 54 to 574 toggles at the same decay, and the estimated footprint is a flat 56 B per cell with periodicity off; `grid2d` is cheaper per call than `voxel3d` at every tested extent in every timing recording, by a factor that we do not report because it was not measured reliably, alongside 4.4–10.0× more live 3D cells. On this synthetic suite, the results are consistent with a lifelong-mapping core that is written once and shared across dimensions, with the two backends differing in how many cells their geometry creates. Whether the calibrated test improves on FreMEn's own component selection remains to be evaluated (§8); how the evidence rule behaves on real LiDAR data is the subject of Sections 6 and 7.

Backend equivalence of the static layer (E1). The numbers of this paragraph are those of the v0.1 evidence rule (`legacy`, the arithmetic of the first release, which the harness names explicitly). The same scenes run with the sequential test of the current engine (`evidence_model = sprt` at the shipped defaults; `results/e1_static_quality_sprt.csv`) give recall 1.0 from the derived fourth window in all six runs and no false Static cell at any clutter density. With $N_{\min}$=3 a cell needs three touched windows before it may graduate, and recall jumps from 0 to 1.0 exactly at the third window (t=2) for all six backend–clutter combinations, then holds at 1.0 through t=39: clutter never demotes a wall cell (Table 4, Figure 2). Table 4 is the periodicity-off run. With periodicity on at the shipped defaults (T=24, H=2, δ=0.2 spent over the touch count) the run is identical window for window: the wall is occupied whenever it is touched, so its centred amplitude is 0 (Remark 2)

Table 5: Periodicity detection (E2) after 64 windows with the shipped test, $a_{\min}$=0.3, δ=0.2 spent over the touch count, T=8, H=3. *Ref. amplitude* and *Ref. H B* (the Bonferroni-adjusted Chernoff bound of Proposition 3; Periodic needs $\leq \delta_n$) come from a non-pruning reference model fed the identical occupancy stream. Periodic TPR = 2/3, FPR = 0/5. *Outcome* scores the Periodic class; a non-periodic cell ending Static is not a Periodic false positive but is a wrong map label (*false Static*).

Probe cell	Ground truth	Final class	Ref. amplitude	Ref. $H\,B$	Outcome
`door_p8_4on4off` (50% duty)	periodic	Periodic	0.653	$< 10^{-3}$	correct
`door_p8_2on6off` (25% duty)	periodic	Transient	0.462	$< 10^{-3}$	**miss**
`door_p4_2on2off` (50% duty)	periodic	Periodic	0.707	$< 10^{-3}$	correct
`wall_constant`	non-periodic	Static	≈ 0	1	correct
`aperiodic_0`	non-periodic	Static	0.159	1	**false Static**
`aperiodic_1`	non-periodic	Unknown	0.329	0.056	correct
`aperiodic_2`	non-periodic	Transient	0.139	1	correct
`aperiodic_3`	non-periodic	Transient	0.251	0.585	correct

and $d_{i,k} = 0$. The v0.1.0 engine instead lost the whole wall from the Static layer in windows 29–40 (t = 28–39), in all six runs, and ended with Static recall 0 (Table 6). The only errors are false Static cells created when a random mover re-hits one cell often enough to graduate on its own. At 5 movers per window this never happens and precision stays at 1.0; at 25 it saturates at one spurious cell (precision 0.9938); at 100 false statics keep accumulating, from the first extra cell at t=17 (`grid2d`) or t=25 (`voxel3d`) to 174 or 165 predicted cells at t=39. This yields the one material gap between backends, precision 0.9253 against 0.9758. Both runs apply the identical graduation rule, each to its own natively sampled mover stream (movers on the integer lattice for `grid2d`, continuous for `voxel3d`, both confined to one z-plane), so the gap reflects quantisation and sampling rather than the classifier; we do not claim it isolates a single geometric mechanism.

Single-read-out calibration (E0). Table 7 applies the single-read-out rule of §3.4 (level constant in n). The Chernoff bound is conservative at every candidate level. At δ=0.1 the worst null rate over all grid points is 0.0050 and the worst pipeline rate 0.007, both within the 0.01 target, whereas δ=0.2 exceeds it (0.0149 and 0.014). The selected single-read-out level is therefore δ=0.1; the shipped rule replaced it (E5). Relaxing δ from 0.01 to 0.1 shortens the median read-out length at which a 4-on/4-off door becomes stably Periodic from 22 to 15 windows. The Gaussian-residual approximation of the periodogram, the textbook false-alarm formula (Zechmeister and Kürster, 2009), fails the same check: at a level of 0.01 it reaches a null rate of 0.037 for n near T, where binary sequences put real mass on exactly periodic patterns. No E1–E4 seed was used in E0.

Periodicity detection (E2). Both 50%-duty doors are classified Periodic, with reference amplitudes 0.653 and 0.707 and Bonferroni-adjusted bounds below 10^{-3} (Table 5). The constant wall is Static with amplitude exactly 0 at every length. No aperiodic control is Periodic, so at the n=64 read-out the Periodic class reaches a true-positive rate of 2/3 and a false-positive rate of 0/5; the two earliest engines scored 1/5 (v0.1.0) and 2/5 (centred only) at this length. Figure 4 and Table 6 show that this is not a favourable read-out. Over all lengths n = 8–100 the pipeline has no false positive at any length, as with the single-read-out level, against a mean false-positive rate of 0.363 (v0.1.0) and 0.331 (centred), with 0–4 of 5 per length in both. The gain is paid for in detection delay. The true-positive rate is 0 for n = 8–19 and 1/3 at n = 20–24, and it reaches 2/3 at n = 25; the single-read-out level reached it at n = 15 and the two earliest engines from n=8. The mean true-positive rate over the sweep falls from 0.667 to 0.624 (single read-out) and 0.563 (spent).

Two further observations qualify the zero. First, it is no longer owed to pruning. With the single-read-out level, a non-pruning reference model fed the same streams and read with the same predicate called

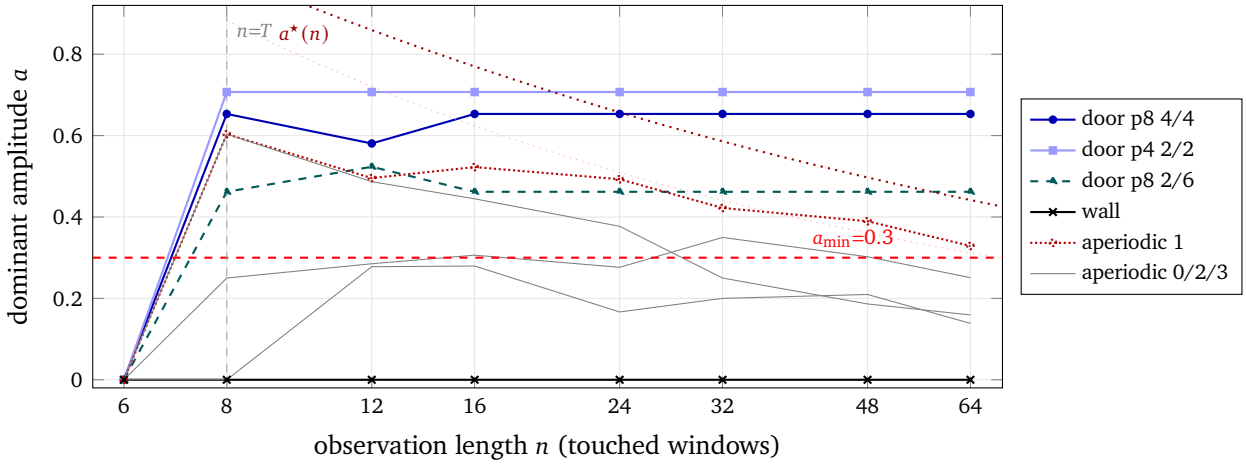


Figure 3: FreMEn-lite amplitude against observation length (E2), from a non-pruning reference model of the corrected engine fed each probe cell's occupancy stream (T=8, H=3). The $n \geq T$ gate forces a=0 at n=6; both 50%-duty doors settle well above $a_{\min}$, and the 25%-duty door would too, yet the live pipeline prunes it first (Proposition 8). The constant wall is exactly 0 at every length because the coefficients are centred (Remark 2); the Bernoulli controls hover near $a_{\min}$. The thick dotted curve $a^\star(n)$ is the amplitude the shipped test requires under uniform phase coverage, with δ=0.2 spent over the touch count and H=3 (Eq. (14) with δ_n of Proposition 4); the thin dotted curve is the single-read-out threshold at δ=0.1. A cell is Periodic only above both $a_{\min}$ and $a^\star(n)$. Plotted from `e2_amplitude_vs_length.csv`.

`aperiodic_1` Periodic at 25 of 93 lengths (n = 29–31, 45–50 and 52–67), a mean false-positive rate of 0.054: at n=64 this cell's amplitude is 0.329 and its bound $H\,B = 0.056 < 0.1$, a genuine tail event of this seed, roughly 3.7 null standard deviations. With the spent level the same reference model (dotted in Figure 4) has no false positive at any length, because $\delta_{64} = 0.2 \cdot 8/(64 \cdot 65) \approx 3.8 \times 10^{-4}$. Second, `aperiodic_0` ends Static. With λ=1 its log-odds is a random walk that reached p_{grad}, and it was previously masked by a spurious Periodic label (centred engine) that demoted it. E2 does not score the Static class; E5 does, over 20 scenes, and finds this failure common (Table 11). The amplitude curves confirm the gate of (11): for the 4-on/4-off door the amplitude is exactly 0 at n=6 < T, 0.653 at every sampled multiple of T ($n = 8, 16, \ldots, 64$) and 0.581 at n=12, where the uncentred v0.1.0 amplitude had overshot to 0.871 (Figure 3). The miss, the 25%-duty door, is not a failure of the test: the reference model detects it at every length from n=57 with the spent level (from n=26 at a single read-out), with amplitude 0.462 at n=64. The live pipeline never gets there, for a reason that follows from the update rule.

Proposition 8 (Prune/maturity race)**.** *Under the E2 parameters (l_{hit}=1, l_{miss}=−1, λ=1, p_{prune}=0.05, T=8), a cell touched every window with the 2-on/6-off pattern is erased by (16) within at most 7 consecutive touched windows of its creation. Hence $n_i < T$ throughout every lifetime, $a_i = 0$, and the cell is never classified Periodic.*

Proof. With λ=1 and unit increments, ℓ_i is an integer walk from 0 (the clamp at ±5 never binds below). Since $\sigma(-2) \approx 0.119 \geq p_{\text{prune}} > \sigma(-3) \approx 0.047$, erasure happens exactly when ℓ_i first reaches −3, provided $a_i < a_{\min}$, which holds while $n_i < T$. If the cell is created with $j \geq 3$ vacant windows left in its cycle, it reaches −3 after 3 windows. If $j \leq 2$ vacant windows remain, ℓ_i reaches $-j$, then $2 - j$ after the two occupied windows, then −3 after $5 - j$ further vacant windows: 7 windows in total. If it is created in an occupied window, $\ell_i \leq 2$ after at most two hits and −3 after five more misses, again at most 7. In every case the lifetime is at most 7 < T=8 touched windows, so $a_i = 0$ by (11) and π_i is false. Erasure also needs $\neg g_i$, which holds because $\ell_i \leq 2$ throughout, so $p_i \leq \sigma(2) \approx 0.881 < p_{\text{grad}}$=0.9 and the cell never graduates. Erasure discards $\boldsymbol{\phi}_i$, so each re-created cell starts again from $n_i = 0$. □

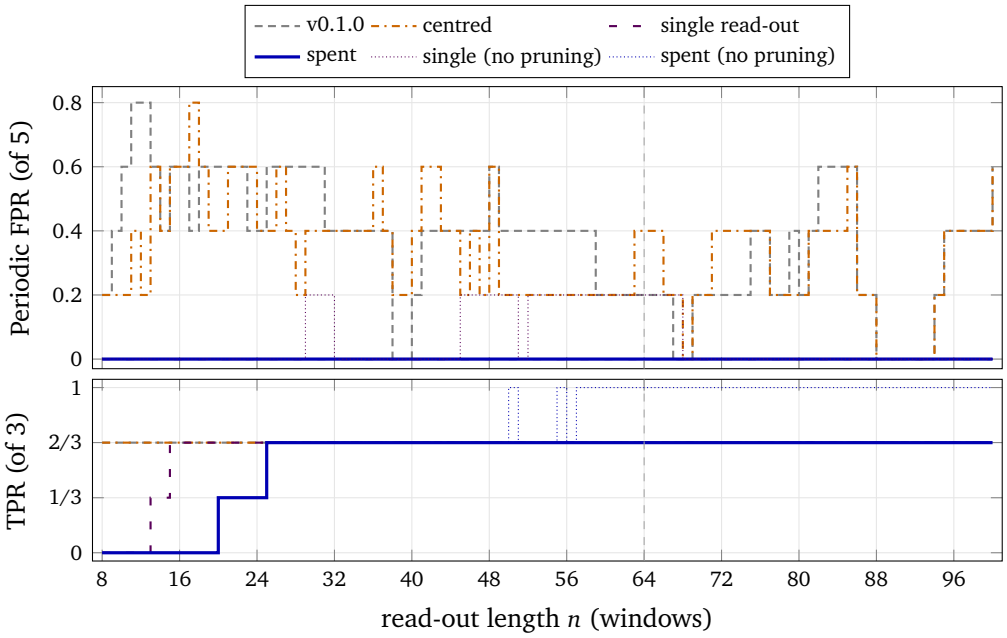


Figure 4: Periodic false- and true-positive rates against read-out length (E2), from the real `LayeredMap`, a fresh map per length, T=8, H=3, $a_{\min}$=0.3, for the four engine versions of Table 6. The dotted lines apply the single-read-out and the spent predicate to a non-pruning reference model fed the same streams (lower panel: spent only). The dashed vertical marks the n=64 read-out of Table 5. The v0.1.0 and centred TPR curves coincide at 2/3. Plotted from `e2_rates_vs_length.csv` and its three archived counterparts.

The race couples the prune rule (16) to the touched-window gate; the reference model, which never prunes, is not subject to it.

Per-dimension cost of the shared engine (E4). In all 13 timing files that exist, `grid2d`'s `integrate()` is cheaper than `voxel3d`'s at every tested extent. All of them were taken on a loaded host or marked invalid, and in those the ratio of median latencies varies between files (9.9–27.6× at 100^2), so only the direction is reported; all files are kept in `results/e4_exploratory/` and `results/e4_recordings/` (Table 8, Figure 5). The live-cell counts are exact: `voxel3d` ends each run holding 10.0×, 6.5× and 4.4× as many cells, because its half-voxel ray march creates a hash entry for every traversed free voxel, whereas exact 2D Bresenham clears a bounded strip. We measured neither ray steps nor the per-cell update cost under each backend separately, so we do not attribute the latency difference to one cause. Memory is not measured: the harness multiplies the live-cell count by a fixed 56 B per cell (per-cell evidence and hash node with periodicity off; table and backend overhead excluded), which gives 37.0 MB for the largest 3D configuration (661,410 cells).

5.3. Trajectory-Level False Alarms and Confusion (E5)

What a deployed map does. E0 and E2 read a cell once per run. The map labels every cell after every window, so the event that matters for a deployed map is that a non-periodic cell is labelled Periodic at *some* window of the run. E5 measures this event directly on held-out seeds, for the live detector with pruning, re-creation and re-testing, over horizons of 64, 256 and 1024 windows (Table 10; every configuration in Table 32).

The single-read-out level does not control it. With δ=0.1 applied at every read-out, up to 84 of 2000 Bernoulli clutter cells are labelled Periodic within 64 windows and 953 of 2000 within 1024

Table 6: Effect of the three corrections to the periodicity test, same harness, seeds and parameters. *v0.1.0*: uncentred amplitude and the amplitude-only rule $a \geq a_{\min}$ (results in `results/pre_fix_2026-09-28/`); *Centred*: centred amplitude, amplitude-only rule (`results/pre_calibration_2026-09-28/`); *Single*: the significance test of Proposition 3 at δ=0.1 at every read-out (`results/pre_spending_2026-09-28/`); *Spent*: the level δ=0.2 spent over the touch count (Proposition 4, current engine). E1 and E3 with periodicity on use the shipped T=24, H=2, $a_{\min}$=0.3; E2 uses T=8, H=3. E1 counts are identical in all six backend–clutter runs.

	Periodicity	Periodicity on			
Measure	off	v0.1.0	Centred	Single	Spent
E1: windows $t \geq 3$ with Static recall < 1	0 windows	12 (t=28–39)	0 windows	0 windows	0 windows
E1: Static recall at t=39	1	0	1	1	1
E2 at n=64: TPR / FPR	–	2/3 / 1/5	2/3 / 2/5	2/3 / 0/5	2/3 / 0/5
E2, n = 8–100: mean FPR	–	0.363	0.331	0.000	0.000
E2, n = 8–100: FP count range (of 5)	–	0–4	0–4	0–0	0–0
E2, n = 8–100: lengths with no FP	–	10 of 93	7 of 93	93 of 93	93 of 93
E2, n = 8–100: lengths with constant wall Periodic	–	4 of 93	0 of 93	0 of 93	0 of 93
E2, n = 8–100: mean TPR	–	0.667	0.667	0.624	0.563
E2: TPR 2/3 at every $n \geq$	–	8	8	15	25
E2, n = 8–100: lengths with FP, no pruning	–	–	–	25 of 93	0 of 93
E3: total flicker, 36 configurations	3672	7132	5472	3792	3672
E3: flicker at p_{grad}=0.9, p_{dem}=0.3, λ=0.90	54	138	102	58	54
E3: flicker at p_{grad}=p_{dem}=0.9, λ=0.90	574	582	596	576	574

Table 7: Calibration of the nominal level δ (E0) on seeds disjoint from E1–E4. *Null*: worst false-alarm rate over the grid of iid Bernoulli(m) streams ($T/H \in \{8/3, 24/2\}$, $m \in [0.05, 0.95]$, $n \geq T$, 20,000 streams per point); *Pipeline*: worst per-read-out rate of 3000 clutter cells in the live `LayeredMap` (E2 parameters, pruning on, n = 8–100); *Door*: median read-out length from which a 4-on/4-off door stays Periodic (40 phases). Rule, fixed before the run: the largest δ with both rates ≤ 0.01. For comparison, the Gaussian-residual approximation of the periodogram at level 0.01 reaches a null rate of 0.037.

δ	Null rate	Pipeline rate	Door, median first n	Selected
0.01	0.0004	0.001	22	no
0.02	0.0007	0.002	20	no
0.05	0.0022	0.003	17	no
0.1	**0.0050**	**0.007**	**15**	**yes**
0.2	0.0149	0.014	14	no (rate > 0.01)

(E2 parameters, m=0.4, 95% interval [0.4547, 0.4984]). The per-window labelling rate stays small, at most 0.0047, but it accumulates over the run. The shipped parameters are affected less, because their slower log-odds walk prunes Bernoulli clutter less often, yet 202 of 2000 cells still flip at some window (m=0.3).

The spent level does. With δ=0.2 spent over the touch count, chosen on the calibration seeds (Table 9), at most 2 of 2000 Bernoulli clutter cells are ever labelled Periodic within 1024 windows in every held-out configuration, a Wilson 95% upper limit of 0.0036, and the per-window rate is at most 3.9×10^{-6}. Always-occupied and always-free cells are never labelled Periodic under either rule. The proved bound of Proposition 4 covers the never-pruned case at 0.2. For pruned clutter the proved bound $\delta\,\mathbb{E}[L_N]$ is vacuous (a Bernoulli(0.4) cell under the E2 parameters begins about 62 histories), and the measured rate sits far below it: the Chernoff bound is conservative, and successive read-outs of one history are strongly correlated, so the union bound over them is loose.

Correlated clutter is flagged. The Markov cells violate the independence the bound assumes: their

Table 8: Size of the map each backend builds from the same number of hits (E4): 150 random hits per window, 20 windows, resolution 1.0, periodicity off. Live-cell counts and memory (at 56 B per cell) follow from the seeded geometry and reproduce exactly; the ratio is voxel3d over grid2d at equal extent. No latency is tabulated (see text).

Backend	Extent	Live cells	Memory
`grid2d`	100^2	8,553	479 KB
`voxel3d`	100^2	85,399	4.78 MB
ratio		*10.0*×	
`grid2d`	250^2	45,657	2.56 MB
`voxel3d`	250^2	295,300	16.5 MB
ratio		*6.5*×	
`grid2d`	500^2	150,096	8.41 MB
`voxel3d`	500^2	661,410	37.0 MB
ratio		*4.4*×	

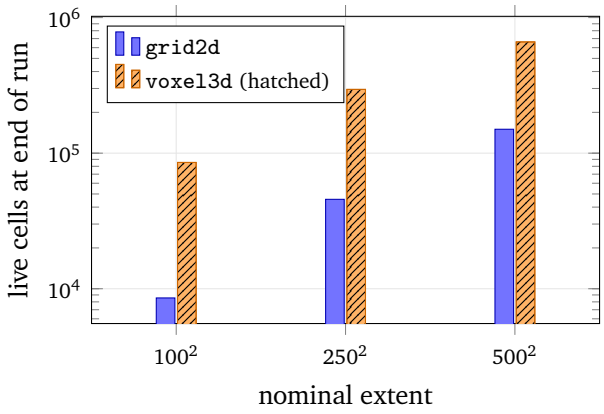


Figure 5: Live-cell count at the end of the run (E4), log scale. The counts are exact and follow from the seeded geometry. Plotted from `e4_throughput.csv`.

occupancy has real power at low frequencies. Under the shipped T=24 the spent test labels 1908 of 2000 of them Periodic within 1024 windows (1998 at a single read-out); at T=8 it labels 2. The periodogram test cannot tell a slow random process from a period of 24 windows; this is a limitation of the null, not a failure of the bound.

What it costs. On held-out seeds the median window from which a noiseless 4-on/4-off door stays Periodic moves from 15 to 25, a 2-on/2-off door from 13 to 20, a 3-on/5-off door from 21 to 31, and a 4-on/4-off door with 10% flipped windows from 26 to 48; at the shipped T=24 a 12-on/12-off door stays at 24 windows, and with 10% flips it moves from 25 to 40. No door run fails to become Periodic.

Four-class confusion. Table 11 scores all four labels over 20 held-out scenes. Under the E2 parameters walls are Static and dynamic cells Transient or Unknown, with one exception in 1000. No cell other than a door is Periodic. All 800 50%-duty doors are Periodic and none of the 400 25%-duty doors, which Proposition 8 proves are never Periodic; the recall of the Periodic class is therefore a property of the scene mix, and we report counts per cell type rather than a recall. Within 256 windows the single-read-out level labels 219 of 2000 aperiodic cells Periodic at some window, the spent level 1. The dominant error is elsewhere: 1221 of 2000 aperiodic Bernoulli(0.5) cells end falsely Static, a share of 0.611 [0.589, 0.632].

False Static labels (E6). The periodicity test does not decide this error; the graduation rule does, and

Table 9: Choice of the spent level δ (E5) on calibration seeds disjoint from every evaluation seed. *Worst ever-Periodic*: over 36 configurations (E2 and shipped parameters, touched every window or with probability 0.5, Bernoulli(m) clutter, $m = 0.1, \ldots, 0.9$, 2000 cells, 1024 windows), the largest count of cells labelled Periodic at some window, with the Wilson 95% upper limit of that rate. *Door*: median first window from which a 4-on/4-off door (E2 parameters, T=8) or a 12-on/12-off door (shipped, T=24) stays Periodic. Rule, fixed before the run: the largest δ whose upper limit is ≤ 0.01 in every configuration.

δ	Worst ever-Periodic (of 2000)	Wilson upper	Door, T=8 / T=24	Selected
0.01	0	0.0019	34 / 33	no
0.02	0	0.0019	32 / 30	no
0.05	0	0.0019	30 / 26	no
0.1	1	0.0028	27 / 24	no
0.2	**2**	**0.0036**	**25 / 24**	**yes**

Table 10: Trajectory-level false alarms of the live detector on held-out seeds (E5). Each entry is the worst Bernoulli(m) clutter configuration over $m = 0.1, \ldots, 0.9$: the number of 2000 cells (10 seeds of 200) labelled Periodic at some window up to N, with its Wilson 95% interval for N=1024, and the worst per-window labelling rate. q: probability that a cell is touched in a window, independent of its occupancy. *Single*: δ=0.1 at every read-out; *Spent*: δ=0.2 spent over the touch count. *Markov*: temporally correlated clutter (two-state chain, mean 0.5, mean dwell 10 windows), outside the null of Proposition 3. Constant cells were never labelled Periodic.

Parameters, touches	Rule	N=64	N=256	N=1024	95% interval, N=1024	Per window	Markov, N=1024
E2, every window	Single	84	280	953 (m=0.4)	[0.4547, 0.4984]	0.0045	349
	Spent	0	1	2 (m=0.4)	[0.0003, 0.0036]	3.9×10^{-6}	2
E2, q=0.5	Single	20	127	543 (m=0.4)	[0.2525, 0.2914]	0.0047	79
	Spent	0	0	2 (m=0.4)	[0.0003, 0.0036]	3.9×10^{-6}	0
Shipped, every window	Single	64	66	202 (m=0.3)	[0.0885, 0.1150]	0.0008	1998
	Spent	2	2	2 (m=0.4)	[0.0003, 0.0036]	1.0×10^{-6}	1908
Shipped, q=0.5	Single	18	52	102 (m=0.3)	[0.0422, 0.0615]	0.0009	1331
	Spent	1	1	1 (m=0.3)	[0.0001, 0.0028]	3.4×10^{-6}	409

decay does not remove it. With λ=0.97 added to the E2 parameters, 1042 of 2000 aperiodic cells still end Static. With the shipped defaults 1960 of 2000 do, a share of 0.980 [0.973, 0.985] (1983 after 256 windows), and so do 11 of 1000 dynamic cells; of the 1200 doors of that scene 1091 are Periodic after 64 windows and all 1200 after 256 (Table 11). With λ=0.97 all 1200 doors of the E2 scenes are Periodic, the 25%-duty ones included; we did not analyse why the race of Proposition 8 is not lost there. Remark 1 gives the reason for the Static labels: the shipped l_{hit}=0.85 and l_{miss}=−0.4 put the mean-field threshold at $m^{\dagger} = 0.354$, so a cell that is occupied in half of its windows drifts up to the clamp. Table 12 measures the transition. With the shipped defaults, 396 of 2000 Bernoulli(0.25) cells are Static after 256 windows, 783 at m=0.30, 1279 at 0.35, 1698 at 0.40 and 1974 at 0.50; and 485 of 2000 Bernoulli(0.10) cells are Static at some window. Symmetric increments ($l_{\text{miss}} = -l_{\text{hit}}$) move $m^{\dagger}$ to 0.525 and the count at m=0.50 to 1156, but they cost noisy walls: of Bernoulli(0.60) cells, which E3 scores as walls, 1741 of 2000 are then Static, against 1998 with the shipped defaults. No parameter set of the sweep separates the two populations. On the 0.05 grid the share of Static cells rises from below 10% to above 95% over an interval of m that is 0.30 wide with the shipped defaults and 0.35 wide with the other three sets. A user who knows the occupancy rate of the clutter to reject and of the walls to keep can place $m^{\dagger}$ between them through l_{miss} and λ, as far as the two rates lie further apart than that interval. We measured only these four sets, on iid cells touched in every window, and changed no default.

Table 11: Four-class confusion on 20 held-out scenes, touched every window, read out after 64 windows with the shipped test (E5 for the E2 parameters, E6 for the others; same seeds). Per scene: 50 walls, 20 doors of each of three types at random phase, 100 aperiodic Bernoulli(0.5) cells, and 50 dynamic cells crossed by a mover with probability 0.1 per window. Doors: 4-on/4-off, 2-on/6-off and 2-on/2-off for the E2 parameter sets (T=8); the same duty cycles at three times the period for the shipped defaults (T=24). *Single P*: Periodic count under the single-read-out rule and, after the slash, cells labelled Periodic at some window up to 256 under the single-read-out and the spent rule (E2 parameters only). The recall of a class over this fixed mix of cell types is a property of the mix, so counts are reported per type.

Parameters	Ground truth (cells)	Static	Periodic	Transient	Unknown	Single P / ever P (single, spent)
E2 (λ=1)	wall (1000)	1000	0	0	0	0 / 0, 0
	door (1200)	0	800	400	0	800 / 800, 800
	aperiodic (2000)	1221	0	672	107	12 / 219, 1
	dynamic (1000)	1	0	705	294	0 / 1, 0
aperiodic cells falsely Static: 0.611 [0.589, 0.632] (Wilson 95%); after 256 windows 1223 of 2000						
E2 with λ=0.97	wall (1000)	1000	0	0	0	–
	door (1200)	0	1200	0	0	–
	aperiodic (2000)	1042	0	861	97	–
	dynamic (1000)	0	0	686	314	–
aperiodic cells falsely Static: 0.521 [0.499, 0.543] (Wilson 95%); after 256 windows 1019 of 2000						
Shipped defaults	wall (1000)	1000	0	0	0	–
	door (1200)	0	1091	18	91	–
	aperiodic (2000)	1960	0	40	0	–
	dynamic (1000)	11	0	917	72	–
aperiodic cells falsely Static: 0.980 [0.973, 0.985] (Wilson 95%); after 256 windows 1983 of 2000						

5.4. Ablation Studies

Hysteresis band versus decay (E3). E3 ablates the two stabilisers of the static layer on identical replayed noise (Table 13, full sweep in Table 30). Removing the hysteresis band has the largest effect in the sweep: at p_{grad}=p_{dem}=0.9 and λ=0.90, the worst configuration, the wall layer flickers 574 times and final F1 drops to 0.810 (recall 0.68), whereas the same noise and decay with the band widened to 0.6 (p_{dem}=0.3) flickers 54 times at F1 1.000, a more than tenfold reduction attributable to the band alone. Among zero-band configurations at λ=0.90, flicker rises with the coincident threshold (250 at 0.7, 343 at 0.8, 574 at 0.9), even though a higher threshold is usually the more conservative choice: a threshold pair with no gap is not a substitute for a band wherever it sits. Decay is second order. Holding the worst pair fixed, flicker falls as forgetting slows (574 at λ=0.90, 150 at 0.97, 122 at 1.0), because faster decay lets noisy log-odds cross the coincident threshold more often; with the widest band, decay barely matters (52–54 toggles across all three settings). Hysteresis, not decay, is what keeps the static layer stable (Figure 6).

Periodicity on (E3). Rerunning the sweep with periodicity on at the shipped defaults leaves final F1 unchanged in every configuration (last column of Table 30), and flicker is now identical to that with periodicity off in every configuration. The total over the 36 configurations is 3672 in both cases, against 3792 with the single-read-out level, 5472 with the centred amplitude-only rule and 7132 with v0.1.0. The widest-band configuration at λ=0.90 has 54 toggles, against 58 (single read-out), 102 (centred) and 138 (v0.1.0). These walls are free in 40% of their windows by construction, so their centred amplitude is sampling noise. Under the amplitude-only rule it crossed $a_{\min}$ often, and the unbanded $\vee\,\pi_i$ demotion (§3.3) toggled the wall out of the Static layer. With the single-read-out level, 1 or 2 such demotions remained per configuration, because each wall was re-tested in every window. With the spent level, the probability that π_i demotes a wall during one uninterrupted history is at most δ (Proposition 4); none is demoted in any configuration.

Table 12: Bernoulli(m) cells labelled Static (E6): of 2000 cells per entry (10 seeds of 200), touched every window, the number Static after 256 windows and, in parentheses, the number Static at some window up to 256. *Shipped, symmetric*: the shipped defaults with $l_{\text{miss}} = -l_{\text{hit}}$. $m^{\dagger}$ is the mean-field threshold of Remark 1. E3 scores Bernoulli(0.6) cells as walls, for which Static is the correct label; E5 scores Bernoulli(0.5) cells as clutter, for which it is an error.

m	E2 (λ=1)	E2, λ=0.97	Shipped	Shipped, symmetric
$m^{\dagger}$	0.500	0.534	0.354	0.525
0.10	0 (65)	0 (44)	11 (485)	7 (395)
0.20	32 (788)	21 (605)	172 (1767)	51 (1618)
0.25	65 (1356)	44 (1098)	396 (1973)	120 (1900)
0.30	138 (1735)	87 (1559)	783 (1995)	196 (1986)
0.35	288 (1921)	177 (1857)	1279 (2000)	320 (1998)
0.40	481 (1996)	367 (1975)	1698 (2000)	537 (2000)
0.50	1206 (2000)	1043 (2000)	1974 (2000)	1156 (2000)
0.60	1797 (2000)	1695 (2000)	1998 (2000)	1741 (2000)
0.70	1965 (2000)	1950 (2000)	2000 (2000)	1965 (2000)
0.80	1998 (2000)	1997 (2000)	2000 (2000)	1999 (2000)

Table 13: Hysteresis and decay ablation (E3), selected rows of the 36-configuration sweep on identical replayed noise (full sweep in Table 30). Band = $p_{\text{grad}} - p_{\text{dem}}$; flicker counts per-window `isStatic` toggles over 80 windows. Bold marks the lowest flicker in the sweep and the worst configuration.

p_{grad}	p_{dem}	Band	λ	Flicker ↓	F1 ↑
0.9	0.9 (deg.)	0.0	0.90	**574**	**0.810**
0.8	0.8 (deg.)	0.0	0.90	343	0.947
0.7	0.7 (deg.)	0.0	0.90	250	0.980
0.9	0.9 (deg.)	0.0	0.97	150	1.000
0.9	0.9 (deg.)	0.0	1.00	122	1.000
0.9	0.3	0.6	0.90	54	1.000
0.9	0.3	0.6	0.97	**52**	**1.000**
0.9	0.3	0.6	1.00	**52**	**1.000**

5.5. The Sequential Test on the Synthetic Suite (sprt Arm and E7)

The sprt arm repeats E0–E6 on the same scenes and seeds with `evidence_model = sprt` at the shipped pair (Table 14); the harness changed only by taking the arm as an argument, and the legacy arm still reproduces its committed files byte for byte (Appendix A). Nothing below is tuned: the periodic levels are chosen again by the pre-stated rules of E0 and E5 and come out as before, $\delta = 0.1$ for a single read-out and $\delta = 0.2$ spent over the touch count.

E1. With the sequential test, recall reaches 1.0 at the window index $t = 3$, the derived 4th window, in all six runs, and the final precision is 1.0000 in every run. The false Static cells that the v0.1 rule created under 100 movers per window (precision 0.9253 for `grid2d` and 0.9758 for `voxel3d`) do not appear.

E2, E5. In E2 the Periodic class has 3/3 true positives and 0/5 false positives at $n = 64$; the 25%-duty door that the prune/maturity race cost the legacy arm is Periodic, because the periodicity gate keeps the cell alive until T touched windows exist. In E5 the largest number of Bernoulli clutter cells of 2000 that are ever labelled Periodic within 1024 windows on held-out seeds is 11 (Wilson 95% upper limit 0.0098), against 2 in the legacy arm: the 0.01 target is met only at the margin. Temporally correlated clutter at the shipped period is labelled Periodic in 1969 of 2000 cells (legacy: 1908), so

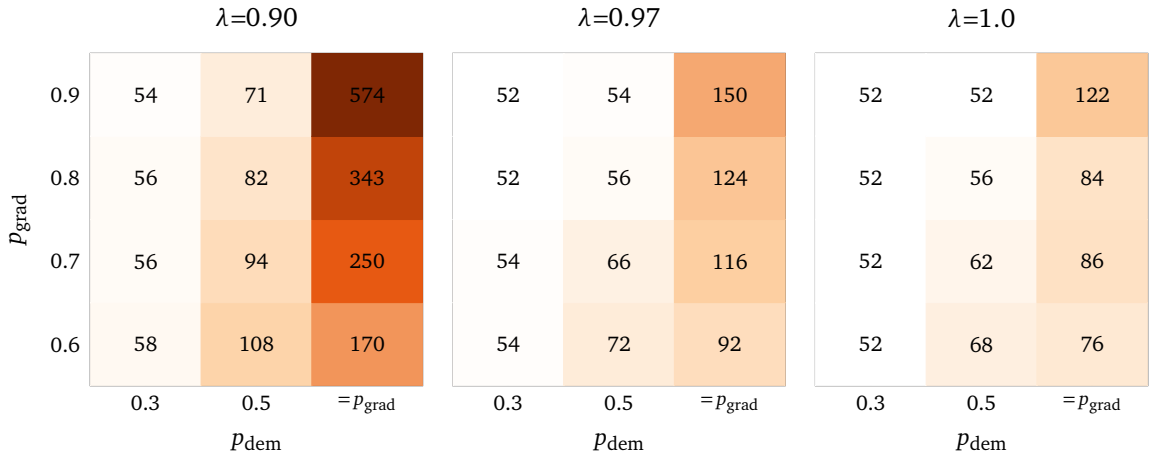


Figure 6: Flicker transitions across the E3 sweep (colour: $\log_{10}$ flicker; annotation: raw count). The zero-band column (p_{dem}=p_{grad}) holds the worst cell of every panel; widening the band suppresses flicker far more than slowing decay does. Plotted from `e3_sensitivity.csv`.

the limitation of the null is unchanged.

E3. E3 has no p_{grad}, p_{dem} or λ in the sprt arm; it sweeps four pairs at three error rates instead (Table 15). At the shipped pair with $\alpha = \beta = 0.01$ the wall layer has recall 0.90 and 101 toggles; over the 12 rows the flicker lies between 48 and 169. The latency and the number of all-miss windows that demote a wall are consequences of the pair and the error rates, not tuned constants.

E6. With the shipped pair, 1120 of 2000 Bernoulli(0.5) cells are Static at window 64, against 1960 in the legacy arm, and 0 of 1000 dynamic cells; 1 of the 2000 is read out Intermittent after 256 windows. A Bernoulli(0.5) cell lies between m_0 and m_1 and above the zero-drift rate $m^* = 0.4391$, where the test promises nothing and drifts upward. After 256 windows, 2 of 2000 Bernoulli(0.20) cells are Static (107 at some window), 52 at $m = 0.30$, 378 at 0.40, 1101 at 0.50, 1745 at 0.60 and 1948 at 0.70. Of the 1200 doors of the shipped-default scene, 1119 are Periodic after 64 windows and all 1200 after 256. The share of Static cells rises with m along the operating characteristic of Table 3, not at a point.

E4 and E7. The cell counts of E4 grow slightly, for example 8,553 to 9,077 live cells for `grid2d` at 100^2; no timing was recorded for the sequential test. E7 (Section 4.5, Tables 3 and 2) compares the engine with the exact lattice computation and Wald's closed form and measures the effect of autocorrelation; it is the experiment behind the claim that the error rates hold for independent windows.

6. Calibrating the Pair on Real Data

A pair (m_0, m_1) is a statement about the sensor, the window length and the resolution: the hit rate that structure reaches and the hit rate that clutter does not exceed. Section 4 makes the user state it. This section asks whether we can state it from data. We set the procedure down in a pre-registration before the first measurement, applied it to calibration sequences that are separate from the test sequences of Section 7, and report the outcome. *The outcome is that nothing froze.* The shipped pair is the pair that the procedure would give if the failed quality gate were waived, and it is labelled provisional wherever it appears.

Table 14: The synthetic suite in both arms. *Legacy*: the v0.1 arithmetic with the explicit parameters of the first release; *sprt*: the sequential test at the shipped defaults, same scenes and seeds. Counts are cells of the scene mix stated with each experiment (Section 5.1). A shipped-default Bernoulli(0.5) cell lies between m_0 and m_1, where the test promises nothing.

Measure	Legacy	Sprt
E1: first window with Static recall 1.0 (index t)	2	3
E1: final precision, `grid2d` / `voxel3d`, high clutter	0.9253 / 0.9758	1.0000 / 1.0000
E2 at n=64: Periodic true / false positives	2/3, 0/5	3/3, 0/5
E5: worst ever-Periodic of 2000 Bernoulli cells within 1024 windows (spent level)	2	11
E5: Markov clutter ever Periodic, shipped period, of 2000	1908	1969
E6: Bernoulli(0.5) cells Static at window 64, shipped defaults, of 2000	1960	1120
E6: dynamic cells Static at window 64, shipped defaults, of 1000	11	0
E6: Bernoulli(0.5) cells read out Intermittent at window 256, of 2000	–	1
E4: live cells, `grid2d` at 100^2	8,553	9,077

6.1. Procedure

Data and split. The calibration set holds the LILocBench (Trekel et al., 2025) sequences `mapping`, `static_0` and `dynamics_0` (2D, a wheeled robot in an office), the KTH benchmark (Zhang et al., 2023) sequence KITTI 00 (3D, 64 beams, a single drive) and, after a re-split described below, the Oxford Spires (Tao et al., 2024) sequence Keble 02 (3D, 64 beams, one site). The test set holds the sequences of Section 7. The split, the statistic, the thresholds and the rule below were committed before any test-sequence file was opened; the files of the test set were recorded with size and modification time before and after each phase, and every later read of a test file is listed in an access log. The re-split moved Keble 02, the lowest-numbered Keble sequence that has a ground-truth trajectory (a rule that does not look at content), from the test set to the calibration set, in an amendment committed before any test file was opened. It was needed because KITTI 00 alone, a short drive, cannot show whether most structure voxels can be decided by a sequential test.

Cells and labels. For each cell touched in at least five windows, the hit rate is $r = H/N$ with H the windows with a hit and N the touched windows. A miss is a window in which a ray passed through the cell to a return beyond it; a beam without a return adds nothing. Structure cells are those that the reference holds as occupied (LILocBench: occupied in `static_0`; KITTI 00: static voxels above the ground; Keble 02: voxels of the terrestrial-laser-scanner map, restricted to the area around the trajectory). Clutter cells are those in which something moves (LILocBench: cells hit in `dynamics_0` that were free in the mapping reference; KITTI 00: voxels that hold a point flagged dynamic; Keble 02: hits that the terrestrial map does not contain). The window is one second, the length of the windows of the node: 15 scans at 15 Hz in 2D, 10 scans at 10 Hz in 3D. A first calibration run used ten scans per window (0.67 s at 15 Hz); the one-second condition was added before the freeze step.

Rule. Let q_s be the 10th percentile of the hit rate over structure cells and q_c the 90th percentile over clutter cells. The pre-registered escalation rule has three steps. (i) If $q_s - q_c \geq 0.15$, take $m_0 = \lceil q_c \rceil_{0.05}$ and $m_1 = \lfloor q_s \rfloor_{0.05}$, rounded toward each other so that the stated error rates cover the measured percentiles, with $\alpha = \beta = 0.01$. (ii) Otherwise measure the gap again with a refined miss that does not count a miss next to the endpoint of a grazing beam (3D only). (iii) Otherwise add a second

Table 15: Sweep of the pair and the error rates (E3, sprt arm): 50 noisy walls (occupancy 0.6) among 10 movers per window, 80 windows, same replayed noise in every row, periodicity off. α=β in the second column. *Latency*: windows an always-hit cell needs; *Demote*: all-miss windows that demote a graduated cell. The sweep picks nothing; a row is a consequence of its pair. The ceiling margin is not swept because it does not enter the dynamics of a cell that is not at the ceiling.

m_0	m_1	α=β	A	Latency	Demote	Recall	F1	Flicker
0.2	0.7	0.05	2.944	3	4	0.78	0.876	169
0.2	0.7	0.01	4.595	4	5	0.90	0.947	101
0.2	0.7	0.001	6.907	6	8	0.96	0.980	60
0.2	0.6	0.05	2.944	3	5	0.94	0.969	113
0.2	0.6	0.01	4.595	5	7	0.98	0.990	65
0.2	0.6	0.001	6.907	7	10	1.00	1.000	52
0.3	0.7	0.05	2.944	4	4	0.58	0.734	143
0.3	0.7	0.01	4.595	6	6	0.84	0.913	68
0.3	0.7	0.001	6.907	9	9	0.80	0.889	48
0.1	0.5	0.05	2.944	2	6	1.00	1.000	72
0.1	0.5	0.01	4.595	3	8	1.00	1.000	54
0.1	0.5	0.001	6.907	5	12	1.00	1.000	52

Table 16: Quality gates of the calibration sequences (P1b, pre-registered thresholds from the sensor specifications). G1: wall thickness of planar patches (median and 90th percentile of the thickness, metres); G2: leave-one-out pose consistency (median and 90th percentile of the distance, metres). Limits are written under the column names. A sequence that fails a gate is excluded from the headline tables. *No sequence passes*, so the pair derived from them is not frozen.

Sequence	Class	G1 patches	G1 median / p90	G1 limits	G2 median / p90	G2 limits	G1, G2
`lil_mapping`	2D	590	0.1930 / 0.2506	0.1 / 0.2	0.0012 / 0.0048	0.05 / 0.1	FAIL, PASS
`lil_static_0`	2D	391	0.1705 / 0.2545	0.1 / 0.2	0.0013 / 0.0060	0.05 / 0.1	FAIL, PASS
`lil_dynamics_0`	2D	470	0.1832 / 0.2285	0.1 / 0.2	0.0021 / 0.0276	0.05 / 0.1	FAIL, PASS
`kitti00`	3D	41	0.3720 / 0.4713	0.2 / 0.4	0.0387 / 0.1113	0.1 / 0.2	FAIL, PASS
`keble02`	3D	2251	0.3212 / 0.4627	0.2 / 0.4	0.0174 / 0.0415	0.1 / 0.2	FAIL, PASS

statistic on run lengths (Option C). In every branch the remaining overlap is reported as irreducible. The truncation $n_{\max}$ is the smallest multiple of 16 for which at most 3% of cells at the zero-drift rate m^* are still undecided under the exact rule.

Quality gates. A hit-rate percentile is only as good as the map that carries it. Two gates were fixed from sensor specifications before the measurement. G1 measures the thickness $\sqrt{12\lambda_{\min}}$ of linear (2D) or planar and vertical (3D) patches of the accumulated points. It passes if the median and the 90th percentile of the thickness stay under limits derived from the error of the sensor and of the poses (Table 16); the limit of the 90th percentile is twice that of the median. G2 measures pose consistency: each return is compared with the returns of scans one to four seconds away, and the median and 90th percentile of the distance to the nearest returned point must stay within one and two cells of the finest grid of the sensor class. A sequence that fails a gate is excluded from the headline tables; the 2D pair needs all three LILocBench sequences to pass.

Table 17: Hit-rate gap of structure against clutter on the calibration sequences. q_s: 10th percentile of the per-cell hit rate over structure cells; q_c: 90th percentile over clutter cells; both for cells touched in at least five windows. The pre-registered rule needs a gap $q_s - q_c \geq 0.15$. Block intervals over 10 m tiles in brackets. *LIL*: LILocBench, 2D, structure of `static_0` against hits in free space of `dynamics_0`. *KITTI 00*: KTH benchmark, 3D, structure voxels against voxels that hold a moving point (first calibration run, ten scans per window). *Keble 02*: Oxford Spires, 3D, structure against TLS-absent hits. m_0, m_1: the rounding rule of Section 6, defined only when the gap passes; all rows fail a quality gate (Table 16).

Data	Cell, window	q_s	q_c	Gap [block interval]	≥ 0.15	(m_0, m_1)	Cells (struct. / clutter)
LIL	0.05 m, 15 scans	0.7130	0.1725	0.5404 [0.4435, 0.5795]	yes	(0.20, 0.70)	10,126 / 23,888
LIL	0.10 m, 15 scans	0.7222	0.2381	0.4841 [0.3746, 0.5183]	yes	(0.25, 0.70)	4,582 / 6,220
KITTI 00	0.2 m, 10 scans	0.1250	0.1667	-0.0417 [-0.1071, -0.0238]	no	–	121,651 / 5,791
Keble 02	0.2 m, 10 scans, today's miss	0.4667	1.0000	-0.5333 [-0.6000, -0.4762]	no	–	195,641 / 15,864
Keble 02	0.2 m, 10 scans, refined miss	0.5357	1.0000	-0.4643 [-0.5333, -0.4000]	no	–	192,255 / 13,990

Table 18: Evidence for a second statistic (Option C) on the calibration data: cells matched on hit rate (bands of width 0.2), lag-1 autocorrelation of the window outcomes. AUC: probability that a structure cell has a larger lag-1 autocorrelation than a clutter cell; above 0.5 means structure has the longer runs. Pre-registered reading: support for Option C if the AUC is at least 0.65 or at most 0.35 in a band with at least 100 cells in each group.

Data	Hit-rate band	Struct. cells	Clutter cells	Lag-1, struct.	Lag-1, clutter	AUC	Reading
LIL, 0.05 m, 15 scans	$[0.2, 0.4)$	99	1,382	0.329	0.360	0.493	fewer than 100 cells
	$[0.4, 0.6)$	337	172	0.474	0.274	0.665	support, structure longer
	$[0.6, 0.8)$	1,288	91	0.468	0.231	0.720	fewer than 100 cells
Keble 02, 0.2 m, 10 scans	$[0.2, 0.4)$	7,782	2,055	0.311	0.010	0.736	support, structure longer
	$[0.4, 0.6)$	13,988	2,102	0.396	0.020	0.771	support, structure longer
	$[0.6, 0.8)$	27,402	2,526	0.368	-0.006	0.776	support, structure longer
KITTI 00, 0.2 m, 10 scans	$[0.2, 0.4)$	25,052	137	0.154	0.360	0.338	support, structure shorter
	$[0.4, 0.6)$	22,018	134	0.260	0.339	0.468	between
	$[0.6, 0.8)$	19,036	147	0.179	0.272	0.436	between

6.2. Result

The gates. G2 passes on all 5 calibration sequences. G1 fails on all 5: the median patch thickness on the three 2D sequences is between 0.1705 and 0.1930 m against a limit of 0.1 m (Table 16). We cannot say whether the cause is the poses, the time base of the scans or the walls themselves. A search for the time offset between scans and poses was run on the `mapping` sequence by a procedure written before use; a first calibration run without it measured pose-timing smear more than hit rates. The gate also fails on an exploratory run without the offset. Because no sequence passes, every table below is printed for the record and is not a headline table.

The hit-rate gap. In 2D the gap is large: $q_s = 0.7130$, $q_c = 0.1725$, a gap of 0.5404 with a block-bootstrap interval of [0.4435, 0.5795] over 10,126 structure and 23,888 clutter cells (Table 17). The rounding rule gives $(m_0, m_1) = (0.20, 0.70)$. The intervals of q_s and q_c cross rounding boundaries, so the pair at both ends of the interval is $(0.20, 0.65)$ and $(0.30, 0.75)$; both are evaluated in Section 7. At the coarser resolution of 0.1 m the rule gives $(0.25, 0.70)$. With the pair $(0.20, 0.70, 0.01, 0.01)$ the derived quantities are those of Table 1, among them $n_{\max} = 80$ and an always-hit latency of 4 windows. In 3D the gap is negative under both miss definitions: $q_s = 0.4667$ against $q_c = 1.0000$ on Keble 02, a gap of -0.5333 with today's miss and -0.4643 with the refined miss, and -0.0417 on KITTI 00 ($q_s = 0.1250$, $q_c = 0.1667$). The Keble 02 result is not evidence that hit rates do not separate people from structure in 3D: 64.3 % of the clutter cells lie more than half a metre above the device, so the clutter class is mostly not walking people. On KITTI 00 a structure voxel is touched in a median of 4 windows (14 windows close), too few for a sequential test to decide most of them; a lifelong mapper needs revisits.

A second statistic. The pre-registered reading counts support for Option C if the lag-1 autocorrelation of the window outcomes separates structure from clutter at matched hit rate, with an AUC of at least 0.65 or at most 0.35 in a band with at least 100 cells in each group (Table 18). It does, with opposite signs: in LILocBench (AUC 0.665) and Keble 02 (0.736 to 0.776) structure has the longer runs; in KITTI 00 (0.338) it has the shorter ones. A statistic whose sign changes between datasets is not a fixed rule, and we did not implement Option C. This is a measured outcome, not a decision that the gap rule made.

The pair on its own calibration data. Replayed through the engine on the three one-second 2D sequences, the shipped pair with the Periodic veto on leaves 1.51 % of the 22,273 clutter cells whose observed hit rate is at most m_0 ever Static, 30.5 % of those above m_0, and 3.71 % of all 24,096 clutter cells. These per-cell rates exceed the per-history level $\alpha = 0.01$ for the reasons of Section 4.4; they are the calibration rows that the held-out rates of Section 7 are read beside.

6.3. What froze and what did not

Nothing froze. The 2D pair $(0.20, 0.70, 0.01, 0.01)$ is the result of the rule with the failed gate waived, not a freeze. The 3D rule gave no pair, and the 3D backend falls back on the 2D pair, which is *not calibrated for 3D*. The shipped defaults are therefore provisional: the node logs this at start and publishes it on its diagnostics topic, and a test of the library fails if the library defaults, the shipped parameter files and the pre-registration record disagree. The pair is valid only for one-second windows, the resolutions measured and the sensors measured. We evaluate the point pair and both ends of its interval in Section 7 so that the reader sees how much the answers depend on the pair.

7. Evaluation on Held-Out Real Data

This section reports what seven evidence rules do on real LiDAR data that none of them was fitted to. It tunes nothing and picks no winner: the pair of the sequential test was fixed before the first test-set run, and the tables show how the answers move with the rule. The wording of the outcomes is ours and follows the numbers of the tables; the pre-registration (`PREREG_P3.md`, with dated amendments) fixes the datasets, the arms, the metrics and the reporting rules before the first run.

7.1. Design

Arms. All arms run through the same engine, with a window update per touched window, so that the rows differ only in the evidence rule.

- *shipped v0.1*: the rule of the first release, l_{hit}=0.85, l_{miss}= – 0.4, leak 0.97, graduate at 0.8 after three touched windows, demote at 0.45 (`evidence_model = legacy`).
- *symmetric*: the same with $l_{\text{miss}} = -l_{\text{hit}}$.
- *OctoMap parameters on window evidence*: the probabilities 0.7 and 0.4 of the OctoMap sensor model (Hornung et al., 2013) as increments, its clamps, no leak, occupied if $\ell > 0$, never pruned. The increments are applied once per touched window, not once per ray and scan, so the row is not OctoMap and its numbers are not comparable to published OctoMap rows.
- *ELite factors on window evidence*: odds factors 9 and 1/9 per touched window, no leak, occupied if $\ell > 0$. These are the factors that Eq. (5) of ELite (Gil et al., 2025) gives for an endpoint

and for a sampled free point at zero distance from the ray (our arithmetic from the printed equations; the paper states no clamp, and we set ±50). The row is not ELite.

- *SPRT* $(0.20, 0.70)$: the sequential test of Section 4 at the shipped pair, $\alpha = \beta = 0.01$; *SPRT low end* $(0.20, 0.65)$ and *high end* $(0.30, 0.75)$ are the pairs at the ends of the calibration interval (Section 6). These two rows show the dependence on the pair; they change nothing about the first.

The OctoMap and ELite arms have no Undecided state: "not Static" is "Rejected" for them. We did not build an arm for MTD-Map (Kim et al., 2026): we found no released code, and a reimplementation from the paper alone would fix choices that the paper does not fix.

Datasets and what each can show.

- *LILocBench* (Trekel et al., 2025), `lt_changes_dynamics_0` (with people) and `lt_changes_0` (a control without people), 2D, 0.05 m cells, 15 scans per window (1.0 s). The truth is a reference map of the `mapping` session: a cell that was free there and is hit here is clutter or moved furniture, a reference-occupied cell is structure. No per-object truth exists. The test sequences come from the same building and robot as the calibration sequences, so they test the pair on new recordings and new people, not on a new environment.
- *Oxford Spires* (Tao et al., 2024), Keble sequences 03 to 05 against the terrestrial-laser map, 3D, 0.2 m and 0.1 m voxels, 10 and 20 scans per window. The sequences are from one day; there are no seasons and no doors. The clutter class is hits that the terrestrial map does not contain.
- *KTH dynamic-map benchmark* (Zhang et al., 2023), KITTI 05 (64 beams) and the semi-indoor sequence (16 beams), 3D, one pass, 0.2 m and 0.1 m voxels, windows of 10 and 2 frames. Score: static accuracy SA, dynamic accuracy DA, their geometric mean AA, with the benchmark's point-wise rule (the evaluator applies a 0.05 m tolerance in double precision). A single pass cannot show lifelong behaviour.
- *Boreas* (Burnett et al., 2022), three sessions of one route in late autumn, spring and summer, 3D, 0.2 m, ranges 3 to 25 m, Periodic veto off. There is no truth for structure or clutter; the sessions are compared with each other.

Settings and reporting rules. Cells with fewer than five touched windows are not eligible for any rate. The Periodic veto is the same for all arms of a run: on is the primary setting (the node ships it), off the secondary setting, which isolates the evidence rule; the Boreas stage runs with the veto off only. Each run records host, load, commit, parameters and the checksums of its inputs, and every run is reported, the failed ones included: 622 runs ended with return code zero and 14 with a non-zero one. Intervals are Wilson intervals, which treat cells as independent, and, where tiles are known, the 95% percentile interval of a bootstrap over 10 m tiles. The block interval is the one to read. Two kinds of row were defined after results existed: the near-wall rows of Table 20 and the ever-Static bound of the Spires clutter rows; they are marked report-only, and the bound is not used in the text.

7.2. Nominal against realised false Static labels (LILocBench)

The level $\alpha = 0.01$ is a bound per history under independent windows (Proposition 7). The quantity in Table 19 is per cell: the share of eligible clutter cells that were Static at the close of any window of the run. A rejected cell is erased and its next hit starts a new history, so the unit differs from the bound, and the windows of a cell are autocorrelated (Table 2). For SPRT $(0.20, 0.70)$ the share is 8.81 % of the 38,538 eligible clutter cells (Wilson [8.53, 9.10]; tile-block interval [6.34, 12.54]). Restricted to the 34,580 clutter cells whose observed hit rate is at most m_0 it is 2.93 % (Wilson [2.76,

Table 19: False Static labels on clutter (LILocBench, 2D, 0.05 m cells, 1.0 s windows, Periodic veto on). Clutter: cells that were free in the mapping session and were hit at least once, touched in at least five windows. *Ever Static*: share of those cells Static at the close of any window; *at most* m_0: the same restricted to cells whose observed hit rate is at most m_0=0.20; *block*: 95% percentile interval of a bootstrap over 10 m tiles (read this one); Wilson 95% in brackets treats cells as independent. *End*: share Static at the end of the run; *Und.*, *Rej.*: shares of clutter cells that end Undecided or Rejected (arms without an Undecided state show 0). The nominal level α=0.01 is per history under independent windows and is not the unit of this table. The upper block has people; the lower block (`lt_changes_0`) has none and is a control. Moved furniture puts structure into cells that were free in the mapping session, so the upper block is an upper bound for people alone. The OctoMap and ELite rows apply their increments once per touched window; they are not the published methods.

Arm	Ever Static, all [Wilson]	block	Ever, $\leq m_0$	End	Und.	Rej.
shipped v0.1	21.16 % [20.76, 21.57]	[17.49, 29.32]	13.90 %	7.53 %	85.20 %	7.27 %
symmetric	21.40 % [21.00, 21.82]	[17.76, 28.43]	14.41 %	5.96 %	76.89 %	17.15 %
OctoMap parameters on window evidence	35.18 % [34.70, 35.66]	[32.35, 46.78]	28.07 %	8.19 %	0.00 %	91.81 %
ELite factors on window evidence	11.33 % [11.02, 11.65]	[9.08, 15.13]	4.99 %	4.22 %	0.00 %	95.78 %
SPRT (0.20, 0.70)	8.81 % [8.53, 9.10]	[6.34, 12.54]	2.93 %	4.15 %	92.62 %	3.23 %
SPRT low end (0.20, 0.65)	8.93 % [8.65, 9.22]	[6.46, 12.65]	2.99 %	4.40 %	92.43 %	3.16 %
SPRT high end (0.30, 0.75)	6.41 % [6.17, 6.66]	[4.21, 8.92]	1.61 %	3.26 %	93.32 %	3.42 %
shipped v0.1	17.58 % [17.12, 18.05]	[12.62, 25.74]	7.19 %	9.39 %	84.68 %	5.93 %
symmetric	17.85 % [17.39, 18.33]	[12.36, 25.55]	7.81 %	6.91 %	77.84 %	15.25 %
OctoMap parameters on window evidence	26.15 % [25.62, 26.70]	[20.28, 38.53]	15.45 %	9.94 %	0.00 %	90.06 %
ELite factors on window evidence	11.81 % [11.41, 12.21]	[7.78, 16.64]	2.23 %	6.25 %	0.00 %	93.75 %
SPRT (0.20, 0.70)	9.01 % [8.66, 9.37]	[5.07, 12.63]	0.71 %	5.52 %	91.46 %	3.02 %
SPRT low end (0.20, 0.65)	9.13 % [8.78, 9.49]	[5.14, 12.74]	0.73 %	5.94 %	91.11 %	2.95 %
SPRT high end (0.30, 0.75)	6.83 % [6.53, 7.15]	[3.35, 8.76]	0.15 %	4.62 %	92.01 %	3.37 %

3.11]; tile-block interval [1.87, 3.70]). *Both are above* α, and we do not claim that the realised rate is within the nominal level. On the calibration sequences the same code and pair gave 1.51 % at or below m_0 and 3.71 % for all clutter (Section 6.2); the held-out rates are 1.9 and 2.4 times these rows. Table 2 shows the direction of the effect: autocorrelation of the windows raises the per-history share above α (ratio 3.49 for the engine at lag-1 autocorrelation 0.23, 12.30 for the bare walk). The other arms graduate more clutter. Over all eligible clutter cells, shipped v0.1 gives 21.16 %, symmetric 21.40 %, OctoMap parameters on window evidence 35.18 % and ELite factors on window evidence 11.33 %; at or below m_0 they give 13.90 %, 14.41 %, 28.07 % and 4.99 %. The two ends of the pair give 8.93 % and 6.41 % for all clutter.

The control without people, `lt_changes_0`, gives 9.01 % over all clutter and 0.71 % at or below m_0 for SPRT (0.20, 0.70). The all-clutter rate is close to the rate with people. Moved furniture legitimately puts structure into cells that were free in the mapping session, so the rate of `lt_changes_dynamics_0` is an upper bound for people alone, and the control does not isolate the effect of people either. A person who lingers in a cell can produce a hit rate above m_0, and a hit-rate test cannot tell such a person from a wall.

Undecided cells. In the arms with an Undecided state, most clutter cells end the run Undecided: 92.62 % for SPRT (0.20, 0.70) and 85.20 % for shipped v0.1. The two binary arms end 91.81 %

Table 20: Walls, latency and near-wall thickening (LILocBench `lt_changes_dynamics_0`, veto on). *Wall runs*: 366 reference-occupied cells on straight wall runs. *Rej.*: share Rejected at the end; *Not S*: share not Static at the end; *Windows*: median and 90th percentile of windows from first touch to the first Static window (one window is 1.0 s). *Near wall*: cells free in the mapping session within 0.10 m of an occupied cell, n=6441, share Static at the end and ever Static (definition added after the results were seen, so report-only).

Arm	Rej.	Not S	Windows (p50 / p90)	Near wall, end	Near wall, ever
shipped v0.1	0.00 %	1.09 %	10 / 49	20.17 %	39.59 %
symmetric	0.55 %	9.02 %	10 / 50	13.91 %	38.50 %
OctoMap parameters on window evidence	1.37 %	1.37 %	1 / 33.6	22.23 %	54.32 %
ELite factors on window evidence	5.19 %	5.19 %	1 / 43	9.30 %	23.54 %
SPRT (0.20, 0.70)	0.00 %	14.21 %	33 / 156	8.09 %	16.63 %
SPRT low end (0.20, 0.65)	0.00 %	12.84 %	33 / 156	8.66 %	16.92 %
SPRT high end (0.30, 0.75)	0.00 %	21.04 %	41 / 190	5.64 %	10.25 %

(OctoMap parameters) and 95.78 % (ELite factors) of the clutter cells Rejected; SPRT (0.20, 0.70) rejects 3.23 %. Rejection waits for the touched windows of the periodicity gate, which is one reason for the Undecided share of the sequential arms; we did not measure how much of it the gate explains.

7.3. Walls, latency and near-wall cells

On the 366 wall-run cells, SPRT (0.20, 0.70) and shipped v0.1 reject none (upper Wilson limit 1.04 %); symmetric rejects 0.55 %, OctoMap parameters 1.37 % and ELite factors 5.19 % (Table 20). The share of wall-run cells that are not Static at the end is 14.21 % for SPRT (0.20, 0.70), 21.04 % for its high-end pair and 1.09 % for shipped v0.1. The windows from first touch to the first Static window have a median and 90th percentile of 33 and 156 for SPRT (0.20, 0.70), 10 and 49 for shipped v0.1, and 1 and 33.6 for OctoMap parameters; one window is 1.0 s. A longer wait is expected: the threshold $A = 4.5951$ of the sequential test is higher than the 1.386 of shipped v0.1. These numbers are not the latency of Section 4.5, which is that of an always-hit cell and is 4 windows; real wall cells are not always hit.

Cells that were free in the mapping session and lie within 0.10 m of an occupied cell, two cells wide at 0.05 m, are where a wall thickens (Table 20, 6441 cells, defined after the dumps existed). At the end of the run 8.09 % of them are Static for SPRT (0.20, 0.70), 20.17 % for shipped v0.1, 9.30 % for ELite factors and 22.23 % for OctoMap parameters; ever Static, 16.63 %, 39.59 %, 23.54 % and 54.32 %.

7.4. Oxford Spires: 3D, with a terrestrial reference

In 3D the 2D pair is used and is not calibrated, and the clutter class is weak (Table 21); the rates are not evidence about people. At 0.2 m with 10 scans per window and the veto on, the share of the 18,791 clutter cells of Keble 03 that is Static at the end is 28.28 % for SPRT (0.20, 0.70) against 44.28 % for shipped v0.1; on Keble 04 and 05 it is 37.49 % and 28.18 % against 52.12 % and 41.18 %. The share of non-ground structure that ends Undecided is 16.76 %, 22.50 % and 21.00 % for SPRT (0.20, 0.70) on Keble 03, 04 and 05, against 7.07 %, 10.56 % and 9.50 % for shipped v0.1. The share Rejected is 0.70 % to 0.77 % for SPRT (0.20, 0.70), 0.33 % to 0.66 % for shipped v0.1, 7.45 % to 11.17 % for OctoMap parameters and 11.70 % to 16.81 % for ELite factors. The median windows

to the first Static window of non-ground structure are 5 to 6 for SPRT (0.20, 0.70) and 3 to 4 for shipped v0.1; this population is not that of the LILocBench latency.

The Static sets of the three same-day sequences agree with a Jaccard index of 0.562, 0.645 and 0.720 for SPRT (0.20, 0.70) (pairs 03/04, 03/05, 04/05, in 90 shared tiles), against 0.643, 0.706 and 0.789 for shipped v0.1 (Table 22). **Memory.** At 0.1 m with the veto on, every arm ran out of memory on Keble 03 (7 failed runs), and the later 0.1 m runs of those arms were not started and are listed. With the veto off all 42 runs at 0.1 m finished. The semi-indoor KTH runs at 0.1 m with the veto on failed for all arms in the same way (7 runs). All 14 failed runs ended with `std::bad_alloc` at the 9 GB limit of the harness.

7.5. KTH benchmark: one pass

The KTH rows are a single pass with a pair that is not calibrated for 3D, and no row is a competitive removal score (Table 23). The dynamic accuracy of the oracle map that holds exactly the ground-truth static points is 96.20 on KITTI 05 and 94.42 on the semi-indoor sequence. A DA above the oracle is possible only for a map that drops static points: SPRT (0.20, 0.70) reaches DA 98.99 and ELite factors 97.55 on KITTI 05, and they pay in SA (66.90 and 87.72). At 0.2 m with 10 frames per window, the veto on and the policy *static only*, the rows (SA, DA, AA) are: shipped v0.1 90.20, 83.19, 86.62; symmetric 87.31, 74.40, 80.59; OctoMap parameters 98.55, 55.75, 74.12; ELite factors 87.72, 97.55, 92.50; SPRT (0.20, 0.70) 66.90, 98.99, 81.38. Under the policy *not rejected*, SPRT (0.20, 0.70) keeps every point (SA 100.00, DA 0.00) because no voxel is Rejected in this pass, and shipped v0.1 gives SA 99.99 and DA 4.99. On the semi-indoor sequence the AA with the policy *static only* is 74.45 for shipped v0.1, 79.22 for symmetric, 73.40 for OctoMap parameters, 73.34 for ELite factors and 77.16 for SPRT (0.20, 0.70). Exporting every frame point gives SA 100 and DA 0 in the 9 conditions that finished (5 with the veto off, 4 with it on); this is the check that the exporter and the evaluator are correct.

7.6. Boreas: across seasons

The three Boreas sessions are mapped independently and, for comparison, once cumulatively. Table 22 gives the Jaccard index of the independent Static sets in the 617 10 m tiles seen by all three sessions, for the pairs autumn/spring, autumn/summer and spring/summer: 0.509, 0.405 and 0.489 for SPRT (0.20, 0.70); 0.568, 0.447 and 0.535 for shipped v0.1; 0.544, 0.440 and 0.514 for ELite factors; 0.582, 0.469 and 0.538 for OctoMap parameters. The share of the Static cells of the cumulative map that are Static in no independent session is 20.65 % for SPRT (0.20, 0.70), 13.28 % for shipped v0.1, 0.71 % for ELite factors, 0.17 % for OctoMap parameters and 41.82 % for the high-end pair. Boreas has no truth for structure or clutter, so these are agreements and not accuracies, and a higher agreement is not a better map. The ground-height difference between the sessions is reported with the data and was not applied.

7.7. The Periodic veto

The veto changes some rows a great deal (Table 24). The largest relative effect is the KTH dynamic accuracy under the policy *not rejected* on KITTI 05 at 0.2 m with two frames per window: for SPRT (0.20, 0.70) it is 23.14 with the veto on against 1.16 with it off, about 20 times; the low end gives 22.82 against 1.22 and the high end 24.45 against 1.15. The largest relative effect on a truth-labelled false reject is the Spires false reject of non-ground structure, between 2.5 and 3.0 times: 0.70 % to

0.77 % with the veto on against 0.24 % to 0.32 % with it off. The veto also changes memory use, as above. No run of this study contains a door with a known schedule, so these rows say what the veto does to the evidence rule, not whether it finds doors.

7.8. What these runs cannot show

The runs cannot show per-object truth (LILocBench has none), seasons and doors (Spires covers one day), a removal-benchmark score (the KTH sequences are a single pass, the pair is not calibrated for 3D, and the OctoMap and ELite rows are not the published methods), or any false-Static or false-reject truth in Boreas. They cannot show that Periodic is right on real data, because no sequence has a door with a logged schedule. They show how seven rules differ on the same cells and how a stated nominal level relates to what happened on real clutter.

8. Discussion and Limitations

What the evidence shows about the test. The synthetic evidence supports three statements. The increments of the first release are a sequential probability ratio test whose hypotheses were implied, not chosen (Section 4.1); the operating characteristic of the test of version 0.2 on the real engine matches the exact computation of the rule and is approximated by Wald's closed form, and its error bound holds under independent windows (E7); and the same bound is inflated by autocorrelated windows (Table 2). The real-data evidence supports a narrower statement: on LILocBench clutter the sequential test graduates fewer cells than the rules of the first release, at the price of a longer wait to graduate walls and of more Undecided structure on Spires, and the realised per-cell rate is above the nominal per-history level. It does not support a statement that the sequential test is the better map: the compared rows differ on different measures in different directions, and each dataset leaves one measure out (Section 7.8).

Why the realised rate is above the nominal level. Three things differ between the bound and the table. The unit differs: the bound is per history, the table counts cells, and a rejected cell starts a new history. The windows are autocorrelated, and E7 shows the direction of that effect. The clutter class is not pure: moved furniture and lingering people have a hit rate above m_0, and no hit-rate test tells them from a wall. We did not separate the three contributions on the real data, so the factor between the realised and the nominal rate is not explained.

What the evidence shows about the backends. Across E1–E4 the two backends behave as one engine wearing two geometries. E1's near-identical F1 trajectories and E4's live-cell counts are the empirical face of (1): `LayeredMap` and `PeriodicityModel`, exercised directly in E2 and E3, never see which backend produced the id they update. The backends diverge in two places, the high-clutter precision gap and the per-call cost. Both runs execute the same classifier code on differently sampled input; neither difference was isolated to one mechanism.

Cost Analysis. The window update is linear in the number of live cells (§3.5), so cost is governed by how many cells a backend creates. The flat voxel hash is the source of `voxel3d`'s 4.4–10.0× larger live-cell count: every sampled free voxel becomes its own entry, at an estimated 56 B with periodicity off, with no spatial compression. OctoMap (Hornung et al., 2013) and UFOMap (Duberg and Jensfelt, 2020) collapse coherent free or occupied regions into single octree nodes and would scale better to very large, sparsely occupied 3D extents. We accept the trade for $O(1)$ insert and lookup and a backend simple enough to unit-test without ROS; even the largest configuration tested needs 37.0 MB.

Forgetting outside the field of view. Remark 3 is an operational limitation, not a footnote. Decay

runs only inside the touched branch, so a transient object that accumulates strong evidence and then leaves sensor coverage for good—a box dragged into a corridor the robot no longer visits—keeps its evidence indefinitely. Forgetting in STRATA is coupled to re-observation, not to elapsed time. In a bounded, frequently re-swept environment, the setting E1–E4 implicitly assume, this rarely matters; in a sparsely revisited one it is a real failure mode that the current code does not address.

Free space is remembered. The same coupling shows in `grid2d`'s free value. A cell that a ray has cleared reads free while its last observation was free and no Periodic, Static or occupied-leaning Transient class claims it, so free means last observed free, not currently free. An obstacle that appears where the sensor no longer looks reads free until it is observed; from its first hit it reads 50, out of view too, until a ray observes the cell free again. Free space is also carved only along beams that return a hit inside the array (§3.1): a beam without a return, or one that ends beyond the array, clears nothing, so open space bounded only by such beams stays Unknown, and occupied evidence along them is never contradicted. A map smaller than the sensor's range therefore keeps cells that a model clearing every ray would release. The bit costs one byte per grid cell; `voxel3d` publishes no free space.

Scan-counted windows depend on the input rate. With `window_mode scans` a window is `layer_interval` integrated messages, so its length in seconds, and the period that `period_windows` stands for, follow the rate of messages the node actually integrates; messages lost on a best-effort link, dropped for missing TF or skipped by an overloaded node stretch every window. In the synthetic ROS check, withholding 40 % of the scans turns the tested door cells static (at least 95 %, none periodic) with scan windows (`grid2d`), while time windows keep the door periodic in `grid2d` and out of the static map in `voxel3d`; the continuous integration (CI) asserts all three. Time windows trade this for rate-dependent evidence: a window with few messages is less likely to see a hit, so a sensor rate that varies with the phase of a cycle can itself look periodic, outside the null of the test. Once a second the node publishes on `/diagnostics` the input rate, the lost share (estimated per sensor frame from stamp gaps, valid while about a fifth of consecutive messages arrive back to back; above about 80 % loss, set `expected_scan_rate_hz`), TF failures, the window duration and the period in seconds. It warns on lossy or jittery scan windows, empty or thin time windows, zero or stalled stamps and a stalled simulation clock, names a failing TF lookup, and turns ERROR when input or integration stops; Table 28 gives the exact levels and the check behind each. With time windows the period is `period_windows` × `window_period_s` seconds; a deployment should measure the rates on the robot, keep a window long enough to hold several messages, and choose `period_windows` from the period it wants to detect. The experiments integrate every message and are unaffected.

Design trade-offs. Three simplifications are deliberate. A single global `survival_decay` replaces the per-cell survival posterior of Rosen et al. (2016) and the learned transition rates of Tipaldi et al. (2013) and Saarinen et al. (2012); E3 shows that, once paired with hysteresis, one uniform rate already yields F1 1.000 at both λ=0.90 and 1.0, but a scene with sharply heterogeneous per-cell dynamics is untested. The flat hash trades memory scaling for simplicity, as above. And two backends behind an `if/else` factory is the right amount of mechanism for two, but a third backend would argue for a registry such as `pluginlib` (Open Robotics, 2024); this is a design judgement, not a measured result.

When not to use STRATA. It is not a substitute for SLAM: it estimates no pose and closes no loops, so a deployment without an external localizer publishing the `map`→sensor transform has no path to a map. It is not multi-session mapping: comparing Monday's map with Friday's or replaying a past session needs the versioning of LT-mapper or Yang et al. (2024). It has no object-level reasoning, unlike the object-level change reasoning of Khronos (Schmid et al., 2024). And it does not discover

periods: where the relevant cycles are unknown or are not harmonics of one base period, FreMEn's selection among candidate periods (Krajník et al., 2017) or warped hypertime (Krajník et al., 2019) is the better tool. Within those bounds—one continuous session behind an external localizer, at the raw cell level, in 2D or 3D—it is the intended fit.

Limitations of the real-data evidence.

- *Provisional defaults.* The pair $(0.20, 0.70, 0.01, 0.01)$ is the result of the calibration rule with a failed quality gate waived; the pre-registration is not frozen (Section 6). It is valid for one-second windows and the 2D sensor and resolutions measured.
- *The 3D pair is not calibrated.* No 3D measurement passed the rule, the Keble 02 clutter class is mostly not walking people, and the 2D pair is used in 3D. Every 3D row of Section 7 carries this limit.
- *Realised rates above nominal.* The per-cell false-Static rates on real clutter are above α, for reasons that we did not separate (above). No guarantee of this paper is stated for real windows.
- *Periodic is not validated on real data.* No public sequence has a door with a logged schedule. The veto is on in the primary runs and its effect is measured only as on against off; whether it finds doors, or labels slow clutter Periodic, is shown only on synthetic streams (E5).
- *Memory.* At 0.1 m with the veto on, 14 runs ended out of memory at the 9 GB limit of the harness (Keble 03 and the semi-indoor KTH sequence); the veto-off runs finished. A Fourier record is allocated for every cell touched with the veto on (Section 3.5), the likely cause; we did not measure it.
- *Single pass and a pair that is not calibrated.* The KTH sequences are one pass, so they say little about lifelong behaviour and no row is a removal score. The OctoMap and ELite rows apply their increments once per touched window and are not the published methods; no arm for MTD-Map was built.
- *No truth in Boreas; one day in Spires; people and furniture mixed in LILocBench.* The Boreas comparison is agreement between sessions, not accuracy. The test sequences of LILocBench come from the same office and robot as the calibration sequences.
- *Revisits.* The sequential test waits for evidence. On a single pass part of the structure stays Undecided (up to 22.50 % of the non-ground structure of a Spires sequence), and a lifelong mapper needs revisits that these data do not contain.

Limitations of the synthetic evidence. The synthetic numbers come from a deterministic seeded harness driving hand-authored hit and miss patterns through the engine; the FreMEn grid of Krajník et al. (2016), ELite, LT-mapper and Berrio et al. (2022) report long-term real-world evidence of a kind that this paper does not. E1–E4 are single-seed and carry no dispersion estimate; only E5 to E7 are multi-seed. No FreMEn model is run on the same streams, so this paper does not show that the calibrated test labels periodic cells better than FreMEn's amplitude-ranked component selection. The synthetic evidence establishes a transparent state machine, not a reliable scene classifier: aperiodic cells of moderate occupancy end Static in both arms, low-duty doors are lost to pruning in the legacy arm under the E2 parameters, and at the shipped period correlated clutter is labelled Periodic (below). E4 reports no latency: its timing recordings establish only which backend is cheaper per call. The ROS node has not been run on a robot or on a recorded bag: its evidence is the unit tests of its ROS-free helpers and the synthetic scenarios of Table 28, which continuous integration runs on ROS 2 Humble only, in one container image; the zero-stamp rule, the no-window-closing warning and the sensor-frame cap and expiry have no dedicated check. The saved map was loaded by `nav2_map_server`

in that Humble job only; no other distribution is in the continuous integration, and the node does not verify a saved pair itself. The engine models single-session persistence only, forgets only what it re-observes (Remark 3), and loses low-duty-cycle periodic cells to the prune/maturity race of Proposition 8. The periodicity test has limits of its own. What is proved (Propositions 3 and 4) is a per-history bound under an iid null and occupancy-independent touches: at the shipped level, a cell that is never pruned is labelled Periodic at some window of the run with probability at most 0.2. The 0.01 target is a measurement: at most 2 of 2000 clutter cells within 1024 windows on held-out seeds (E5, legacy arm; 11 in the sprt arm), and for pruned clutter the proved bound grows with the number of re-created histories. The Wilson limits quoted with it are computed per configuration and are not adjusted for the 36 held-out clutter configurations examined. Temporally correlated clutter violates the null, and at the shipped T=24 the test labels most slowly switching cells Periodic (1908 of 2000 in E5). Spending costs detection delay: a noiseless 50%-duty door with T=8 needs 25 windows instead of 15, and one with 10% flipped windows 48 instead of 26. Finally, the dominant labelling error is not periodic at all. The graduation rule labels a cell Static when it is occupied in more than roughly $m^{\dagger}$ of its touched windows (Remark 1; 0.354 with the v0.1 defaults), so it cannot separate random clutter from a noisy wall of similar occupancy: E3 scores Bernoulli(0.6) cells as walls and E5 scores Bernoulli(0.5) cells as clutter, and with the v0.1 defaults 1998 and 1974 of 2000 such cells are Static after 256 windows (E6). Version 0.2 replaces those defaults by the sequential test; between m_0 and m_1 the test promises nothing, and E6 measures what it does there (Section 5.5). The natural next steps follow directly: a null that allows temporal correlation, for example by testing the harmonic against a local noise floor rather than against white noise, and an anytime-valid test that also covers re-created histories and correlated windows; a FreMEn baseline on the same synthetic streams; a second statistic whose sign is stable across datasets; a pair that passes the quality gate, with revisit-rich data in 3D; a recording of a door with a logged schedule, which would be the first real-data test of Periodic; field deployment on a 2D wheeled platform and a 3D-LiDAR platform; per-cell learned decay; exempting recently active cells from pruning, or feeding a running amplitude estimate into (16); and relaxing untouched cells toward the prior on a tick basis, without changing the touched-cell path that E1–E4 characterise.

9. Conclusion

STRATA decides between durable and plastic with a sequential probability ratio test whose two hit rates and two error rates the user states. We showed that the OctoMap increments of the first release are such a test between the hit rates 0.1975 and 0.4621, with hypotheses that were not chosen, and that a multiplicative leak removes the property on which its error bound rests. Engine version 0.2 derives increments and thresholds from $(m_0, m_1, \alpha, \beta)$ and ends every cell Static, Rejected or Undecided. Under independent windows clutter at a hit rate of at most m_0 graduates in one cell history with probability at most 0.0101; the operating characteristic of the engine matches the exact computation of the rule and is approximated by Wald's closed form; and at a lag-1 autocorrelation of 0.23 the per-history rate is 3.49 times the bound, so we state no guarantee for real windows. The pre-registered calibration did not freeze: the wall-thickness gate failed on every calibration sequence, the shipped pair $(0.20, 0.70, 0.01, 0.01)$ is provisional, and the 3D pair is not calibrated. On held-out LiDAR data from LILocBench, Oxford Spires, the KTH benchmark and Boreas, seven evidence rules differ in direction on different measures, and we pick none. On LILocBench clutter the realised per-cell rate of the sequential test is 8.81 % (2.93 % at an observed hit rate of at most m_0) against 21.16 % for the rule of the first release; both are above the nominal per-history $\alpha = 0.01$. The same per-cell state machine serves a 2D grid and a 3D voxel hash and builds without ROS under 114 behaviour-level tests. Its FreMEn-style periodic label has a false-alarm bound for iid clutter; on held-out synthetic

seeds it labels at most 2 (legacy arm) and 11 (sprt arm) of 2000 Bernoulli clutter cells Periodic at some window within 1024 windows, and it is validated on synthetic streams only. STRATA is offered as a small module whose defaults are provisional: re-derive the pair for your sensor, your window length and your resolution, and read the realised rates beside the nominal ones.

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A. Reproduction

STRATA is released under the Apache-2.0 license at https://github.com/kjungmo/strata and targets ROS 2 Humble.

Code pin. The engine (`strata_core`), the node (`strata`) and the check scripts (`scripts/`) of the repository https://github.com/kjungmo/strata that this paper describes are those of commit `a7559d4` (19 October 2026), which adds the evidence model `sprt`; the experiment harness, the result files and this manuscript were completed after that commit without changing those three directories, and the number check compares their tree identifiers with that commit's. The first release of this manuscript pinned an earlier commit with the v0.1 evidence rule (tag `paper-v1`); the pin moved once, on purpose. The harness runs every seeded experiment in two arms: the *legacy* arm, the v0.1 arithmetic with the explicit parameters of the first release, reproduces the earlier result files byte for byte (`paper/experiments/check_legacy_equivalence.sh`), and the *sprt* arm writes new files `results/*_sprt.csv`.

What reproduces. `paper/experiments/check_reproduction.sh` rebuilds the harness from a clean checkout and requires every result file of E0–E3, E5 and E6 (both arms) and of E7 to come out byte for byte; `paper/experiments/reproduction_log.txt` lists the compilers with which it did (GCC 9.4.0 with libstdc++, on one x86-64 Linux host). The result is not independent of the C++ standard library. The streams come from `std::mt19937`, whose output the standard fixes, through three standard distributions, whose algorithms it does not fix. With clang 23.1.2 and libc++ (`check_stdlib.sh`, record in `results/stdlib_libcxx/`), 15 of the 19 seeded result files are byte-identical and four differ: the two E1 files, the E0 door file and the E6 confusion file. These are the experiments whose outcome depends on integers drawn with `std::uniform_int_distribution` (mover cells in E1's `grid2d` runs, door phases in E0 and E6). Under libc++ the final `grid2d` precision at high clutter in E1 is 0.9583 with 168 predicted cells instead of 0.9253 with 174, and every other final value of Table 4 is unchanged; five of the 20 E0 door medians move by one window (at δ=0.1, 20 to 21 and 23 to 24) and the selected levels do not change; and 1976 instead of 1960 of the 2000 aperiodic cells of E6 are Static with the shipped defaults. E5's confusion draws door phases the same way, but its counts do not depend on the phases and its file is identical. 17 of the 20 result files of the sequential-test arm and E7 are byte-identical and three differ (the E0 door file, the E6 confusion file and the E4 cell counts of the sequential-test arm), again the files that depend on integers or reals drawn with a standard distribution; E7 draws from `std::mt19937_64` directly and is identical. No third standard library was tried.

Real data. The datasets are public and are not in the repository; their licences allow statistics and figures, not redistribution. Each is downloaded from its official source into a directory outside the repository. `paper/experiments/realdata/check_realdata.sh` verifies the recorded checksums when the data are present and skips cleanly when they are absent. The calibration, the freeze record and the evaluation are `reproduce_p1.sh`, `reproduce_p1b.sh` and `reproduce_p3.sh`. The repository holds the summary tables, the JSON results, the step logs (host, load, commit, input checksums), the stat records of the test files before and after each phase, and an access log with a file-open trace of every evaluation step. Cell-level dumps stay outside the repository, so the near-wall rows of Table 20 are copied from the committed report `results_p3/P3_REPORT.md`, which is generated from those dumps, and the number check compares them there. Every other number of Sections 4 to 7 that comes from a run is computed from committed files by `tools/make_v2_artifacts.py` and enters the text as a macro, so the prose of these sections holds no hand-typed measured number.

From the repository root:

- Core engine and unit tests, no ROS required (continuous integration runs the same build with g++, Eigen3 and GoogleTest on `ubuntu-latest`):

```
cmake -S strata_core -B build -DSTRATA_CORE_BUILD_TESTS=ON
cmake --build build && (cd build && ctest)
```

- Unit tests, the calibration E0 (seeds from 20260928), experiments E1–E4 (seed 12345), E5 (calibration seeds from 30260928, evaluation seeds from 40260928) and E6 (sweep seeds from 50260928), each in both arms, and E7 (its own seeds, drawn directly from `std::mt19937_64`), writing the CSVs under `paper/experiments/results/`. E0–E3, E5 and E6 (both arms) and E7 rewrite their files byte for byte. E4 reads the wall clock: this script writes its output to `paper/experiments/build/e4_throughput_local.csv` and fails if a cell count or byte estimate differs from the committed one (`check_e4_local.py`); timings for the paper are recorded separately with `paper/experiments/measure_e4.sh`. The comparison columns of Table 6 are the same harness built against the v0.1.0 `strata_core` (`results/pre_fix_2026-09-28/`), against the centred engine before the significance test (`results/pre_calibration_2026-09-28/`) and against the engine with the single-read-out level (`results/pre_spending_2026-09-28/`):

```
bash paper/experiments/run_all.sh
```

- Tables and plot data of this paper, and the number check (`paper/arxiv_ref/NUMBERS.md`). The check regenerates every table and plot-data file and compares it with the committed one. For the hand-written text it locates each numeral and requires it to be tied to a value recomputed from the result files or the code, or to be listed as structural with a reason (an experiment design constant restated from the harness, a symbol in a formula, a plot layout value). A numeral that is neither fails the check. Its limits are these. Structural numerals, among them the scenario sizes of §5.1 and the design constants written as symbol and value, are not parsed from the harness; they are kept in a committed list (`paper/arxiv_ref/structural_numerals.tsv`), so that changing one fails the check until the list is rewritten on purpose. A numeral that is tied to a recomputed value only by being equal to it, and not by its sentence, could be exchanged for another recomputed value without the check noticing; `NUMBERS.md` gives the count of each kind.

```
python3 paper/arxiv_ref/tools/make_artifacts.py
python3 paper/experiments/number_guard.py
```

Alternative backends can be replayed against the reference scenario of the unit test `Integration.WallStaticMoverTransientDoorPeriodic`.

B. Parameters

Table 25: Engine parameters and shipped defaults (the `LayeredMapParams` struct and both `params/*.yaml` files agree). Geometry and node parameters are not part of the engine: `grid_width/grid_height` 400, `grid_resolution` 0.05 m and origin $(-10, -10)$ m for `grid2d`; `voxel_size` 0.2 m for `voxel3d`; `publish_period` 1.0 s; `window_mode time` in both files (`scans` when the parameter is not set) with `window_period_s` 1.0 s; `expected_scan_rate_hz` 0 (estimated from stamps), `rate_warn_drop_fraction` 0.05, `input_timeout_s` 5 s and `startup_timeout_s` 30 s.

Parameter	Symbol	Default	Meaning
`layer_interval`	L	10	integration ticks per window
`l_hit`	l_{hit}	0.85	log-odds increment on an occupied window
`l_miss`	l_{miss}	−0.4	log-odds increment on a free window
`l_min`, `l_max`	$l_{\min}, l_{\max}$	−5.0, 5.0	clamp bounds
`survival_decay`	λ	0.97	per-window forgetting multiplier
`graduate_prob`	p_{grad}	0.8	probability to graduate to Static
`demote_prob`	p_{dem}	0.45	probability at or below which Static demotes
`min_observations`	$N_{\min}$	3	touched windows before graduation
`prune_prob`	p_{prune}	0.05	erase non-static, non-periodic cells below this
`enable_periodicity`	—	true	run the Fourier model
`periodic_amplitude_min`	$a_{\min}$	0.3	minimum harmonic amplitude (effect size)
`periodic_false_alarm`	δ	0.2	level of the significance test
`periodic_alpha_spending`	δ_n	true	spend δ over the touch count, Eq. (15)
`period_windows`	T	24	base period and amplitude gate
`n_harmonics`	H	2	harmonics per cell
`evidence_model`	—	`sprt`	evidence rule (`legacy`: first release)
`m0`	m_0	0.20	clutter at or below this hit rate (provisional)
`m1`	m_1	0.70	structure at or above this hit rate (provisional)
`alpha`	α	0.01	error rate for clutter at m_0
`beta`	β	0.01	error rate for structure at m_1
`n_max_undecided`	$n_{\max}$	80	windows before the Intermittent read-out

Table 26: Per-experiment deviations from the defaults of Table 25, as compiled into each harness. They are the settings of the legacy arm, which also sets `evidence_model = legacy`; the sprt arm changes only the evidence model to the shipped test and leaves the other settings of this table as they are (E3 sweeps the pairs of Table 15 instead of the first-release knobs). "—": default; "swept": varied over the E3 grid; "n/a": inert because periodicity is off; "false / true": run once each way, periodicity on at the defaults.

Parameter (default)	E1	E2	E3	E4
L (10)	1	1	1	1
`enable_periodicity` (true)	false / true	true	false / true	false
l_{hit} (0.85)	—	1.0	—	—
l_{miss} (−0.4)	—	−1.0	—	—
λ (0.97)	—	1.0	swept	1.0
p_{grad} (0.8)	—	0.9	swept	—
p_{dem} (0.45)	—	0.4	swept	—
$N_{\min}$ (3)	—	5	—	—
p_{prune} (0.05)	—	—	0.01	—
T (24)	—	8	—	n/a
H (2)	—	3	—	n/a
δ (0.2, spent)	—	—	—	n/a

C. Interfaces and State Transitions

Table 27: ROS 2 input/output contract of the `strata` node. Every scan or cloud is transformed with a full 6-DoF lookup of `global_frame` (default `map`) ← sensor frame at the message stamp; a lookup that still fails after the wait of Table 28 drops the message with a throttled warning. The node neither subscribes to `/initialpose` nor broadcasts `map`→`odom`; one mutex serialises integration, publishing, saving and the diagnostics status. Both timers run on the wall clock.

Direction	Name (default)	Type, QoS	Condition
Subscribe	`scan_topic` (`/scan`)	`LaserScan`, sensor data	`grid2d`
Subscribe	`points_topic` (`/points`)	`PointCloud2`, sensor data	`voxel3d`
Publish	`~/map`	`OccupancyGrid`, depth 1, transient local	`grid2d`
Publish	`~/map_points`	`PointCloud2`, depth 1, volatile	`voxel3d`
Service	`~/save_map`	`Trigger`	both (`.pgm`+`.yaml` / `.pcd`)
Timer	`publish_period` (1.0 s)	—	both
Publish	`/diagnostics`	`DiagnosticArray`, depth 10	both, one status a second

Node behaviour that a deployment depends on. The node's rules for time, transforms, input health and saving live in ROS-free headers with their own unit tests, and continuous integration runs the launched node against synthetic input on ROS 2 Humble. Table 28 states each rule as implemented and names the check that exercises it; a rule without a check says so. None of these checks uses a robot or a recorded bag (§8).

Table 28: Behaviour of the `strata` node at the pinned commit and the committed check that exercises each rule. Unit tests are the 71 gtest cases of the node package (`strata/test/`); scripts are in `scripts/` and run in the Humble job of the continuous integration against the launched node with synthetic input. "—": no dedicated check.

Topic	Rule as implemented	Checked by
Time windows	Windows of `window_period_s` on header stamps, in integer nanoseconds from the first stamp. A later stamp closes the open window and every silent one. A stamp more than half a window behind the newest, or more than 10^6 windows ahead, re-anchors the clock after closing the open window.	`test_window_clock` (6 cases); `synthetic_e2e.py` with time windows
Zero stamps	Dropped with time windows, integrated with scan windows; reported as a warning in both.	—
TF wait	The lookup at the message stamp is polled without blocking for 0.1 s of ROS time, at most 1 s of steady time. A ROS clock unchanged for 1 s counts as frozen and is not waited on. A clock that steps past the budget gets 20 ms more. A failed lookup drops the message.	`test_tf_wait` (7 cases); `check_coarse_clock.py`; `check_sim_clock_stall.py`
Input status	One status a second on `/diagnostics`. No message yet: OK, then ERROR after `startup_timeout_s`. Messages stop: ERROR after `input_timeout_s`. Lookups fail before anything was integrated: OK with the failing lookup named, then WARN after `startup_timeout_s`. Lookups fail later: named once nothing was integrated for 1 s, then ERROR after `input_timeout_s`. Every status carries message, integration and TF-failure totals, the running failure streak and the last tf2 error text.	`test_input_status` (18 cases); `check_no_localizer.py` on both backends
Clock and stamp warnings	WARN when `use_sim_time` is set and the ROS clock stands still for 3 s while messages arrive, and when messages are integrated but no time window closes for 10 window periods (and more than 2 s).	`check_sim_clock_stall.py` (clock); — (no window closing)
Rate statistics	Per sensor frame, from the stamps of integrated messages: rate, window duration, and loss estimated from gaps against the 20th-percentile interval or `expected_scan_rate_hz`. At most 16 frames are tracked; a frame silent for 10 window closes is forgotten. WARN on loss above `rate_warn_drop_fraction` or jittery scan windows, and on empty or thin time windows.	`test_rate_monitor` (4 cases); `synthetic_e2e.py` with 40 % of the scans withheld; — (frame cap and expiry)
Saving	`grid2d`: PGM and `nav2_map_server` YAML are written to temporary files, flushed, renamed (image first) and the directory flushed. A save that fails before the renames leaves the previous pair untouched and answers `success: false` with the reason. A failure between the two renames can leave the new image beside the previous YAML, so the YAML records the size and SHA-256 of its image and `check_saved_map.py` verifies a pair; neither the node nor Nav2 runs that check. `voxel3d`: one PCD through the same steps.	`test_map_writer` (25 cases); saved-pair step of the CI job; `synthetic_e2e.py` with `--check-map-server`
Saved-map values	Free 254, Transient and Periodic 100, Static 0, Unknown 205 with thresholds 0.65 and 0.196, so `nav2_map_server` serves free, unknown, occupied and unknown.	`synthetic_e2e.py` with `--check-map-server`: all 160,000 cells of the synthetic scene, which holds no Transient cell
Parameters	Every key of both shipped YAML files is declared by the node and holds the file's value.	`check_param_binding.py` on both backends

Table 29: Cell-class transitions of the legacy evidence model, all evaluated at window close. The transitions of the sequential model are those of Algorithm 2.

From	To	Trigger
Unknown (absent)	Transient	first hit or miss creates the cell: ℓ=0, p=0.5 $\geq p_{\text{prune}}$
Transient	Static	Eq. (7): $p \geq p_{\text{grad}}$, $N \geq N_{\text{min}}$, $\neg\pi$
Transient	Periodic	π, Eq. (13): $n \geq T$ and, for some k, $a_k \geq a_{\text{min}}$ and $H\,B(d_k) \leq \delta_n$
Transient	Unknown (erased)	Eq. (16): $p < p_{\text{prune}}$, $a < a_{\text{min}}$, $\neg g$
Static	Transient / Periodic / Unknown	Eq. (8), then re-read by Eq. (17)
Periodic	Transient / Unknown	π becomes false (pruned only once also $a < a_{\text{min}}$)
Periodic	Static	$\neg\pi$ and Eq. (7) holds
Periodic	—	never graduates while π; never pruned while $a \geq a_{\text{min}}$
Static	—	never pruned while g

D. Extended Results

Table 30: Full E3 sweep (36 configurations, 50 noisy wall cells, occupancy probability 0.6, 10 movers/window, 80 windows, seed 12345). Deg. marks the zero-band configuration $p_{\text{dem}} = p_{\text{grad}}$. F1 to Flicker: periodicity off. *Flicker, P on*: the same sweep with periodicity on at the shipped T=24, H=2, $a_{\min}$=0.3, δ=0.2 spent over the touch count (current engine; its F1 equals the periodicity-off F1 in 36 of 36 rows).

p_{grad}	p_{dem}	λ	Band	Deg.	F1	Precision	Recall	Flicker	Flicker, P on
0.6	0.3	0.90	0.3	no	1.000	1.000	1.000	58	58
0.6	0.5	0.90	0.1	no	1.000	1.000	1.000	108	108
0.6	0.6	0.90	0.0	yes	1.000	1.000	1.000	170	170
0.6	0.3	0.97	0.3	no	1.000	1.000	1.000	54	54
0.6	0.5	0.97	0.1	no	1.000	1.000	1.000	72	72
0.6	0.6	0.97	0.0	yes	1.000	1.000	1.000	92	92
0.6	0.3	1.00	0.3	no	1.000	1.000	1.000	52	52
0.6	0.5	1.00	0.1	no	1.000	1.000	1.000	68	68
0.6	0.6	1.00	0.0	yes	1.000	1.000	1.000	76	76
0.7	0.3	0.90	0.4	no	1.000	1.000	1.000	56	56
0.7	0.5	0.90	0.2	no	1.000	1.000	1.000	94	94
0.7	0.7	0.90	0.0	yes	0.980	1.000	0.960	250	250
0.7	0.3	0.97	0.4	no	1.000	1.000	1.000	54	54
0.7	0.5	0.97	0.2	no	1.000	1.000	1.000	66	66
0.7	0.7	0.97	0.0	yes	1.000	1.000	1.000	116	116
0.7	0.3	1.00	0.4	no	1.000	1.000	1.000	52	52
0.7	0.5	1.00	0.2	no	1.000	1.000	1.000	62	62
0.7	0.7	1.00	0.0	yes	1.000	1.000	1.000	86	86
0.8	0.3	0.90	0.5	no	1.000	1.000	1.000	56	56
0.8	0.5	0.90	0.3	no	1.000	1.000	1.000	82	82
0.8	0.8	0.90	0.0	yes	0.947	1.000	0.900	343	343
0.8	0.3	0.97	0.5	no	1.000	1.000	1.000	52	52
0.8	0.5	0.97	0.3	no	1.000	1.000	1.000	56	56
0.8	0.8	0.97	0.0	yes	1.000	1.000	1.000	124	124
0.8	0.3	1.00	0.5	no	1.000	1.000	1.000	52	52
0.8	0.5	1.00	0.3	no	1.000	1.000	1.000	56	56
0.8	0.8	1.00	0.0	yes	1.000	1.000	1.000	84	84
0.9	0.3	0.90	0.6	no	1.000	1.000	1.000	54	54
0.9	0.5	0.90	0.4	no	0.990	1.000	0.980	71	71
0.9	0.9	0.90	0.0	yes	0.810	1.000	0.680	574	574
0.9	0.3	0.97	0.6	no	1.000	1.000	1.000	52	52
0.9	0.5	0.97	0.4	no	1.000	1.000	1.000	54	54
0.9	0.9	0.97	0.0	yes	1.000	1.000	1.000	150	150
0.9	0.3	1.00	0.6	no	1.000	1.000	1.000	52	52
0.9	0.5	1.00	0.4	no	1.000	1.000	1.000	52	52
0.9	0.9	1.00	0.0	yes	1.000	1.000	1.000	122	122

E. Notation

Table 31: Symbols used in §3.

Symbol	Meaning
C, i	set of integer cell ids; a cell
κ_b, ρ_b	backend key map and free-space ray walk
Γ_b, Φ, Ψ	evidence extractor, engine update, class read-out (Eq. 1)
$h_{i,w}$, $m_{i,w}$	hit and miss counts of cell i in window w
τ_i, o_i, f_i	touched, occupied and free indicators of a window
ℓ_i, p_i	log-odds occupancy and $\sigma(\ell_i)$
N_i, n_i	touched-window counts for graduation and for the Fourier model
g_i, π_i	graduated flag and periodic predicate
a_i, $a_{i,k}$, α_k, β_k	dominant and harmonic amplitudes, harmonic coefficients
$d_{i,k}$, $\mathbf{M}_{i,k}$, B	explained variance, centred phase design, Chernoff tail bound (Eq. 12)
δ, $r^\star$, $a^\star(n)$	nominal level, its critical d, amplitude threshold at uniform coverage (Eq. 14)
δ_n, L_N	level spent at touch count n (Eq. 15); histories begun by window N (Prop. 4)
λ, l_{hit}, l_{miss}	survival decay and log-odds increments (derived ones: Eq. 20)
m_0, m_1, α, β	hit rates and error rates of the sequential test
A, B, $\ell_{\max}$, $n_{\max}$	thresholds, cap and truncation of the test
p_{grad}, p_{dem}, p_{prune}	graduation, demotion and prune thresholds
T, H, ω, $a_{\min}$	base period, harmonics, base frequency, amplitude threshold

F. Trajectory-Level Results in Full

Table 32: All E5 held-out configurations: cells (of 2000) labelled Periodic at some window up to N=1024, and in parentheses the mean number of histories a cell began (pruning and re-creation). Columns: parameter set, touch probability q, rule (S: single read-out, δ=0.1; Sp: spent, δ=0.2).

	E2 parameters (T=8, H=3)				Shipped (T=24, H=2)			
Cell	q=1, S	q=1, Sp	q=0.5, S	q=0.5, Sp	q=1, S	q=1, Sp	q=0.5, S	q=0.5, Sp
Bernoulli m=0.1	3 (266)	0 (266)	3 (133)	0 (133)	1 (76)	0 (76)	0 (38)	0 (38)
Bernoulli m=0.2	141 (180)	0 (180)	77 (91)	0 (91)	77 (41)	0 (41)	40 (21)	0 (21)
Bernoulli m=0.3	620 (112)	0 (112)	330 (57)	0 (57)	202 (12)	0 (12)	102 (7)	1 (7)
Bernoulli m=0.4	953 (62)	2 (62)	543 (32)	2 (32)	88 (2)	2 (2)	58 (2)	0 (2)
Bernoulli m=0.5	717 (23)	2 (23)	350 (12)	1 (12)	67 (1)	0 (1)	50 (1)	1 (1)
Bernoulli m=0.6	199 (5)	0 (5)	96 (3)	0 (3)	42 (1)	0 (1)	52 (1)	1 (1)
Bernoulli m=0.7	16 (1)	0 (1)	12 (1)	0 (1)	9 (1)	0 (1)	18 (1)	0 (1)
Bernoulli m=0.8	4 (1)	0 (1)	6 (1)	0 (1)	2 (1)	0 (1)	4 (1)	0 (1)
Bernoulli m=0.9	0 (1)	0 (1)	0 (1)	0 (1)	1 (1)	0 (1)	0 (1)	0 (1)
always occupied	0 (1)	0 (1)	0 (1)	0 (1)	0 (1)	0 (1)	0 (1)	0 (1)
always free	0 (342)	0 (342)	0 (171)	0 (171)	0 (114)	0 (114)	0 (57)	0 (57)
Markov (correlated)	349 (98)	2 (98)	79 (37)	0 (37)	1998 (15)	1908 (15)	1331 (5)	409 (5)

Table 21: Oxford Spires, Keble College sequences 03 to 05, 3D, 0.2 m voxels, W=10 scans (1.0 s), veto on. The 2D pair is used in 3D and is *not calibrated for 3D*. *Clutter*: TLS-absent hits, share Static at the end of the run (a class in which 64.3 % of the cells on sequence 02 lie more than 0.5 m above the device, so these rates are not evidence about people; the unit is not that of α). *Structure*: non-ground cells of the TLS reference map; Rej. is the share Rejected, Und. the share Undecided at the end; *Windows*: median / 90th percentile of windows from first touch to the first Static window over all labelled cells that were ever Static (a population that is not comparable with the LILocBench latency).

Seq.	Arm	Clutter, Static	Struct. Rej.	Struct. Und.	Windows (p50 / p90)
Keble 03	shipped v0.1	44.28 %	0.33 %	7.07 %	3 / 12
	symmetric	38.67 %	1.87 %	10.94 %	3 / 12
	OctoMap parameters on window evidence	51.39 %	7.45 %	0.00 %	1 / 5
	ELite factors on window evidence	39.45 %	11.70 %	0.00 %	1 / 7
	SPRT (0.20, 0.70)	28.28 %	0.70 %	16.76 %	5 / 16
	SPRT low end (0.20, 0.65)	28.50 %	0.59 %	15.35 %	5 / 16
	SPRT high end (0.30, 0.75)	15.57 %	1.10 %	22.39 %	7 / 19
Keble 04	shipped v0.1	52.12 %	0.66 %	10.56 %	4 / 18
	symmetric	45.38 %	2.92 %	15.33 %	4 / 19
	OctoMap parameters on window evidence	56.27 %	11.17 %	0.00 %	1 / 8
	ELite factors on window evidence	44.78 %	16.81 %	0.00 %	1 / 11
	SPRT (0.20, 0.70)	37.49 %	0.77 %	22.50 %	6 / 73
	SPRT low end (0.20, 0.65)	38.39 %	0.67 %	20.65 %	6 / 68
	SPRT high end (0.30, 0.75)	26.48 %	1.23 %	28.04 %	8 / 165
Keble 05	shipped v0.1	41.18 %	0.52 %	9.50 %	4 / 19
	symmetric	35.69 %	2.50 %	13.91 %	4 / 20
	OctoMap parameters on window evidence	45.36 %	9.80 %	0.00 %	1 / 8
	ELite factors on window evidence	35.28 %	15.85 %	0.00 %	1 / 9
	SPRT (0.20, 0.70)	28.18 %	0.71 %	21.00 %	6 / 83
	SPRT low end (0.20, 0.65)	28.76 %	0.61 %	19.19 %	6 / 83
	SPRT high end (0.30, 0.75)	18.01 %	1.17 %	27.18 %	8 / 173

Table 22: Agreement between sessions. *Spires*: Jaccard index of the Static sets of the three same-day Keble sequences (pairs 03/04, 03/05, 04/05) in the 90 10 m tiles seen by all, 0.2 m, W=10, veto on. *Boreas*: Jaccard index of the Static sets of three independent maps of one route in autumn, spring and summer (pairs autumn/spring, autumn/summer, spring/summer), 617 tiles seen by all, 0.2 m, W=10, ranges 3 to 25 m, veto off. *Only cumulative*: share of the Static cells of the map built over the three sessions in turn that are Static in no independent session. Jaccard agreement is not accuracy: Boreas has no truth for structure or clutter.

	Spires, Jaccard			Boreas, Jaccard			Boreas,
Arm	03/04	03/05	04/05	aut./spr.	aut./sum.	spr./sum.	only cumulative
shipped v0.1	0.643	0.706	0.789	0.568	0.447	0.535	13.28 %
symmetric	0.587	0.659	0.732	0.549	0.437	0.525	13.05 %
OctoMap parameters on window evidence	0.635	0.691	0.753	0.582	0.469	0.538	0.17 %
ELite factors on window evidence	0.636	0.684	0.759	0.544	0.440	0.514	0.71 %
SPRT $(0.20, 0.70)$	0.562	0.645	0.720	0.509	0.405	0.489	20.65 %
SPRT low end $(0.20, 0.65)$	0.582	0.664	0.742	0.511	0.405	0.491	20.57 %
SPRT high end $(0.30, 0.75)$	0.539	0.634	0.706	0.435	0.365	0.420	41.82 %

Table 23: KTH dynamic-map benchmark, single pass, 0.2 m voxels, W=10 frames, veto on, static accuracy SA, dynamic accuracy DA and their geometric mean AA, in percent. KITTI 05 (64 beams, SuMa poses) and the semi-indoor sequence (16 beams, NDT-SLAM poses). Policy *static only* exports the points inside Static voxels; *not rejected* exports the points of every voxel that is not Rejected. The DA of an oracle map that holds exactly the ground-truth static points is 96.20 (KITTI 05) and 94.42 (semi-indoor); a larger DA is possible only for a map that drops static points, and pays for it in SA. Exporting every frame point (policy *all*) gives SA 100 and DA 0 in the 9 conditions that finished. The $(0.20, 0.70)$ pair is not calibrated for 3D, the OctoMap and ELite rows apply their increments once per touched window and are not the published methods, and the numbers are not comparable with published removal scores. No row is a removal method.

	KITTI 05, static only			KITTI 05, not rejected		Semi-indoor,
Arm	SA	DA	AA	SA	DA	static only, AA
shipped v0.1	90.20	83.19	86.62	99.99	4.99	74.45
symmetric	87.31	74.40	80.59	99.87	8.09	79.22
OctoMap parameters on window evidence	98.55	55.75	74.12	98.55	55.75	73.40
ELite factors on window evidence	87.72	97.55	92.50	87.72	97.55	73.34
SPRT $(0.20, 0.70)$	66.90	98.99	81.38	100.00	0.00	77.16
SPRT low end $(0.20, 0.65)$	67.44	98.97	81.70	100.00	0.00	77.77
SPRT high end $(0.30, 0.75)$	44.98	99.56	66.92	100.00	0.00	74.13

Table 24: Effect of the Periodic veto (primary setting: on). *KTH DA*: dynamic accuracy on KITTI 05, 0.2 m, W=2, policy not rejected. *Spires*: share of non-ground structure (label 3) Rejected on Keble 03, 04 and 05, 0.2 m, W=10, SPRT $(0.20, 0.70)$. The veto also changes memory: the 0.1 m Spires runs and the semi-indoor 0.1 m runs finish with the veto off and fail with it on.

Condition	Veto on	Veto off
KTH DA, SPRT $(0.20, 0.70)$	23.14	1.16
KTH DA, SPRT low end $(0.20, 0.65)$	22.82	1.22
KTH DA, SPRT high end $(0.30, 0.75)$	24.45	1.15
Spires Keble 03, structure Rejected	0.70 %	0.24 %
Spires Keble 04, structure Rejected	0.77 %	0.32 %
Spires Keble 05, structure Rejected	0.71 %	0.29 %